

Temptemus Papam

Papal Election Simulation Rules Document

Introduction: Welcome to 1492...

This event simulates a Papal Election in the year 1492. Each person plays a unique character with unique resources and goals. Most of the characters are closely based on real historical figures. There is no one winner of the simulation; instead, each player has a unique set of personal goals. Most players begin with around ten goals, some hard, some easy. **You should expect to achieve several goals, but not all.**

Each person plays a different participant in the election, with unique resources and goals: powerful cardinals vying for the throne; other cardinals leveraging their votes to forward religious, political and personal agendas; functionaries and vote-counters who help run the election; and World Monarchs trying to influence the election from the outside. Characters are assigned based on an online survey. All informational materials for the simulation will be supplied, no research is necessary.

The motivations of the characters in this simulation will be very different from your own. All of them will have some beliefs and goals that you find repugnant and some of them will have all beliefs and goals that you find repugnant! **Understanding interests different from your own is the most important negotiation skill**, and this is a chance to express and practice that skill.

Some characters will compete to become pope, while others have unrelated goals. Your character sheet includes details about your background, personality, and opinions of other characters. All players will wear name tags to help you keep them straight.

The heart of this simulation is faithfully embodying your characters, their goals, flaws, moral stances, fears, and convictions. If one of your goals is “don’t become pope!” then achieving that is as important to you as becoming pope is to those who want the papal throne. It would be easy to ignore the inconvenient goals and uncomfortable desires of your characters and make a cutthroat push for things that seem exciting (money, power). This simulation only works because we trust every one of you **not** to do that, and understand that the goal is not to “win” but *to win as your character*, whatever that means to them. Live that role!

Some of you will experience being at the head of the storm as leaders of great factions; others will experience the frustration of being distant monarchs trapped far from Rome where so much is decided; others will taste what it is like to be a virtuous man trapped between evils; to be a servant trapped between masters; to be a small person overwhelmed by having so much influence on great events; to be an old person watching the achievements of a lifetime fall apart. Every one of your unique perspectives will come together to help us understand the period. Bringing 1492 to life is a team effort, so we can’t thank you enough for giving it your energy and enthusiasm, and being faithful to your characters.

Section 0: Don't Panic:

These rules are very long. You will feel there's too much to keep straight. That's fine. There are *many different things going on* in the simulation, and each character is involved in *a maximum of about 1/3 of them*.

For example, if you're a papal secretary, it doesn't matter to you how armies move through mountain passes—if you're a king, it doesn't matter to you how the papal coronation works. During the simulation you will feel as if you are out of the loop, no matter who you are. This is because there is not one loop, there are about fifteen loops, and no one is in more than a few of them. Even the most powerful king will find his plans helped or hindered by the invisible actions of distant people with unrelated goals. Concentrate on things relevant to your character, and let the complexity give you a taste of the interconnections of real negotiations.

Section 1: Overall Game Guidance:

Setting and Off-Site Players:

Part of Lighthaven E will represent the Sistine Chapel, which is sealed for the election, so no one can go in or out. On-site players represent voting cardinals and functionaries who are in the chapel with them. Anyone caught attempting to break in or out, or who shouldn't be there, will be arrested and executed after the election (unless pardoned by the new pope). Officially, no one can communicate with the outside, but the Cardinals have many tricks for sneaking letters in and out.

Off-site players represent monarchs: kings and queens of France, Spain, England, etc. who are trying to affect the election from a distance. They will be in a separate room during the election, negotiating the grand political games that go on outside the Chapel. Monarchs have many resources, but can only affect the Sistine through their agents, certain Cardinals who will be in contact with them using letters, cell phones, text messages.

The orchestrators running the game are also referred to as “DMs”.

Outline and Timeline:

We have four days dedicated to this simulation, which will run approximately as follows:

- We start with **up to three days of voting**. Votes are held three times per session until someone gets a majority of votes (13 or more).
 - Between days of voting, some characters may take **special between-session actions**. If you can take one of these actions, it will be listed on your character sheet.
- When a cardinal wins a majority of votes and is elected pope, we will have the **Papal Coronation Ceremony**. If the pope is elected in the 1st vote of a session, most of the coronation ceremony will happen that session. If the pope is elected in the 2nd vote of a session, most of the coronation ceremony will happen the next session.
 - If no one has been elected pope by the ninth vote at the end of Day 3, **the Ottomans invade Europe** (see below).
- Between Days 3 and 4 there is the **War Phase**. At the end of Day 3, by 9 PM, every player must email the orchestrators to tell us where you are. In addition, players that

command armies or navies must email the orchestrators by the same deadline to specify how they are using their armies and navies.

- Day 4 is set aside for **post-war negotiations**, the ransoming of any prisoners, and further papal audiences. (And can also serve as flex time if anything strange happens with our schedule.)

Carrying Props, Sheets and Envelopes:

You will have an envelope containing cards representing your resources, as well as your character sheet and printouts of supplementary documents (like these rules). You will be given an envelope large enough to carry these materials, so you don't have your hands full, and so you can hide your materials in case you have something secret.

Costuming:

Nametags will be provided. Minimal costumes will also be provided, including red robes for the cardinals. You can also wear your own circa 1492 clothes if you have them, especially if you are not a cardinal.

Out-of-Character Signal:

Sometimes you will need to go out-of-character briefly, usually to ask for help, ask a rules question, talk to an administrator, or connect out-of-character with a player to defuse tension during a high-stakes encounter. When you do this, **make a fist and hold it up to your head, pressed against your forehead. This is the signal that you are not your character at that moment.**

Role Play Basic Rules of Conduct:

In this kind of game, you should act and speak as if you are your character, saying what your character would say and doing what your character would do. Rather than reading aloud from your character sheet, "My number three goal is to become Vice-Chancellor," you should instead role-play your desire, "Becoming Vice-Chancellor would mean a lot to me and my family."

There are also basic rules of conduct to keep everyone comfortable in this kind of game. Generally avoid touching other players, even if you are acting out a scene in which touching would make sense. If you would touch another character, drop out of character by putting your fist on your head, and describe the action you without actually doing it, i.e. "I pat your shoulder reassuringly."

If scenes become very intense, particularly if you are role-playing a hostile encounter, it is good to also put your fist to your head, drop out of character for a moment and say, "Just checking in, are you doing OK?", to make sure the other player is still comfortable. If you feel overwhelmed or unhappy at any point, feel free to put your fist to your head, drop out of character and say you need a break, or help.

Beginning Sessions:

You should **arrive early if you can**. New letters may also be waiting for you, so if you arrive early you can read them in advance.

Addressing Other Characters:

Role-playing period characters is more immersive when you address people by the names and titles your character would use to communicate respect or disrespect, insulting your enemies, and using formal address for characters you respect. The appropriate ways to address others are listed below. You will also get a pronunciation guide for the names, but no worries if you mess up—it's hard for everyone.

Remember that many of your characters have enemies, and one good way to insult an enemy is to refuse to use his proper title. Your character sheet also contains a list of all characters with your personal opinions of them—you may want to write on your character list what title you want to use for each person (so you can decide whether to be polite or rude). Everyone will mess this up sometimes—if someone is using the wrong address for your character it's appropriate for your character to react (angry, surprised), but you can also use the out-of-character signal and ask “Is your character deliberately messing up my character's title?” to make sure it's an in-character choice and not one of the out-of-character slip-ups we all make. **Characters' titles are on their nametags to make it easier!** But here are the basic guidelines:

- **First names or personal names** are only used (A) by intimate friends or family, or (B) to be condescending/commanding toward inferiors. Otherwise use family names or titles. Monks and monarchs are exceptions to this; monks are Brother Firstname (e.g. Brother Tillio, Brother Mario) while monarchs are King, Queen, or Emperor Firstname.
- **A Cardinal** is generally “**Your Eminence**” or “His Eminence Cardinal So-and-so,” but Cardinals themselves, who are of equal rank to each other, mainly use each other's surnames, i.e. “Carafa,” or “della Rovere.”
- **Monarchs** are “Your Majesty” though the Emperor is usually “Your Imperial Highness.” In the third person monarchs can be called by first name (i.e. Isabella or Henry) or by the name of the places they rule (i.e. “England was very rude to France just now!”)

Particular titles:

- **The Emperor** may be addressed as “Caesar” or by monarchs as “Austria” as a very slightly rude reminder that he hasn't been crowned in Rome yet so isn't quite formally Emperor.
- **The Patriarch of Venice** has the special title “His Beatitude” or just “The Patriarch.”
- Some cardinals have Vatican administrative titles, and may be addressed thus: **Camerlengo Riario**, **Vice-Chancellor Borgia**, **Postulator Sangiorgio** (short for Postulator General) and **Master Torriani** (short for Master of the Sacred Palace).
- **Cardinal d'Aubusson** as commander of the Knights Hospitaller may be called “His Most Eminent Highness d'Aubusson” or “Master of the Hospitallers.”
- **Archbishop Cesare Borgia** is only called “Cesare” by intimate friends; most people call him “Valentino” (referring to the place he is bishop of) or formally “His Grace Valentino.” To insult him you can call him “Bullcalf” referring to bull on the Borgia coat of arms. Cardinal Rodrigo Borgia is often called “The Spanish Bull” by enemies.
- **Papal Chaplain Alessandro Farnese** is “Father Farnese” or “Chaplain Farnese,” or can be called just “Farnese” by superiors, or “Lord Farnese” by commoners from Rome or Viterbo.
- **Master of Ceremonies Johann Burchard** is a priest, so addressed as “Father Burchard.”
- **Queen Anne** may be called “Her Majesty” when referring to her as the Queen of France, or “Her Grace” when referring to her separate function as Duchess of Brittany.
- **Functionary Josquin des Prez** is a lower-class character without a surname—the suffix to his name simply refers to the place he comes from. He should be addressed by first name, “Josquin”.

You may also on rare occasions need to address other ranks or forms of nobility:

- **Dukes/Duchesses** are “Your Grace,” while **Marquesses & Margraves** as well as **Counts/ Countesses and Earls** are all “Your Excellency.” Lower nobles are are **Lordship/Ladyship**.
- **Commoner leaders of republics** like Lorenzo de Medici may *optionally* be called “Your Magnificence” except Giovanni Bentivoglio, tyrant of Bologna who is “First Citizen.”
- **Should one need to address a Sultan**, to be polite Christians may say “Your Puissance” while Muslims say “Commander of the Faithful.” Sultan Qit-Bay of Egypt may be called “Egypt”; to be very rude one may call Ottoman Sultan Bayezid “The Turk.”
- **Widows/widowers of title-holders and most deposed title-holders** retain their titles.
- **Monks, Nuns, & Priests**: Monks are “Brother Firstname,” nuns “Sister Firstname,” and priests “Father Surname.” Being a monk and being a priest are unrelated but can overlap. Being a monk means you have joined a monastic order (like joining a fraternity), while being a priest means you’ve gone through training and been ordained to do religious ceremonies like communion, baptism, and marriage. One can be a monk, priest, both, or neither. Monks who are *also* priests are usually addressed as “Father.” Cardinals who are monks may be called “Brother So-and-so” if the conversation focuses on their monastic status.

Can Characters Have Romances With Each Other?

No. There is lots of evidence for romantic relationships between members of the Papal Conclave, or their staff, but to keep everything comfortable for the players, we are minimizing that. You can persuade each other to form marriage alliances or accept mistresses, represented by Bride cards (for example Alessandro Farnese’s famously beautiful elder sister Julia, or her rival for the title “most beautiful woman in Italy,” the lovely Lucrezia Borgia) but you should not initiate romance plots.

No Active Role-Playing of Prejudices, Sexism and Xenophobia:

All of these characters were, from our perspective, xenophobic, religiously prejudiced, and sexist. Most Italians hate the French, most Frenchmen hate the English, most Florentines hate Pisans, most Romans hate Florentines, almost everyone in Europe hates and fears the Muslim populations of Egypt and the Ottoman Empire, and even the most open-minded consider women inferior to men. These aspects of the characters strongly affected politics in this period, but we are strictly minimizing the expression of such prejudices in our simulation.

While your character may have condescending attitudes toward women, or may be distrustful of a specific enemy country, using overtly racist or sexist language or slurs in role-play is strictly forbidden, even if the real historical figure might have done so. Your character sheet will tell you whom your character hates and fears, and you should let those opinions shape your actions, but the simulation will focus on local rivalries (Florence vs. Pisa, France vs. England), and on political tensions rather than prejudices. For example, characters involved in crusades will discuss it as a military tension (conquering Greece, Ottoman imperial expansion), not a religious or racial one. If you find yourself uncomfortable at any time, or are made uncomfortable by how another player is enacting period prejudices, use the out-of-character signal to tell others that you are uncomfortable, and/or talk to an orchestrator.

Non-Player Characters (NPCs)

Some NPCs may participate in the simulation. These are orchestrators volunteering to portray figures that affect events but don't have full agency the way players do. Some NPCs will never appear in person, but will write and answer letters to you.

While the actions taken by *player characters* are not pre-scripted (you have free reign within the limits of your characters' personalities and goals) NPCs are often required to take certain actions at certain times—actions the historical figures took. If an NPC does something which opposes you or harms your goals, don't take it personally—the NPCs are not here to “win”, but to serve you the players by giving you a more immersive experience.

Some NPCs may show up in person in the simulation.

Do Ask Orchestrators for Advice! You are welcome to ask any orchestrator or NPC for in-character help or out-of-character strategic advice at any time; we won't reveal secrets, but we know the event and can bring details to your attention that you may have forgotten, point out resources you have overlooked, or point out pros and cons of proposed plans. Asking for advice is normal, permitted, and encouraged, about big issues and small!

Magic and Supernatural Stuff in This Simulation?

You will hear characters talking about things like demonic possession, necromancy, astrology, Platonic magic, and enchanted items. This game uses real history which means *the characters certainly believe there is real magic, angels, demons etc.* Attitudes in the period varied and many were skeptical about *particular* forms of magic (for example denying predictive astrology but believing in angels), but in general most people took the reality of magic and miracles as a given, but were uncertain about which kinds were safe or dangerous, and everyone knew that fake holy relics and charlatan alchemists were as common as the real deal. References to magic in the game are to real objects that the actual historical figures believed were magical, for example the common belief that ancient Roman carved gems, often set into rings or amulets, sometimes contained demons or spirits sealed into them using the lost arts of the ancients—both Pope Sixtus IV and Lorenzo de Medici possessed famous examples of such “demon rings” which were credited with serious power. Whether or not such items have a *mechanical* effect within the game, your character should take them seriously, guided by the personality and opinions in your character sheet, and the default attitude should be a healthy mix of general credulity tempered by awareness that scams are common.

Section 2: Character Sheet Contents

Your Character Sheet explains a lot of things about you, including personality, background, and...

Rank and Noble Titles:

Rank represents how high you are in the class system: whether you are a commoner, or have a noble title, or a crown. Rank can be gained but usually not lost. There are four Ranks:

- 1. Commoner 2. Nobility 3. High Nobility 4. Monarch**

All characters in the game are very sensitive to rank and will behave very differently when addressing a peer, an inferior, or a superior. In game, you can rise in rank by being granted a Knighthood or Noble Title by a Monarch or High Noble. Whoever is elected pope will receive Monarch rank. Most characters in the game are content with their current rank, but some characters hope to ascend in rank. Getting a Title from a Monarch means **you owe fealty to that Monarch** and must theoretically do what they say (unless it is just a Knighthood, in which case you are allies but don't need to obey them).

Age and Relative Age:

Your character's age appears on both your character sheet and your name tag, and is important for role-play. When interacting with people, keep their in-game age in mind, since advice from an 18-year-old newly-hired secretary is very different from advice given by a 70-year old Vatican veteran, and when electing someone pope *for life*, electing a man of 79 is very different from electing one of 49.

Allies and Alliances:

Allies are those you trust, and want to help succeed. Helping an ally is almost as important as your own goals. Formal allies have special bonuses for interaction. While at any time you can decide "I want to work with So-and-so," to be an **official ally** you must:

- (A) Begin the game as allies
- (B) Form a Marriage Alliance, by marrying Bride and Groom cards
- (C) Receive a Title from a Monarch, which makes you that Monarch's liegeman; or
- (D) Use some other special means to become allies.

Why bother becoming an official ally if you can help anyone freely? There are three benefits:

- 1. Having a powerful ally raises your status in the eyes of the world.
- 2. **Between sessions you may communicate and negotiate freely with allies** but you may not communicate with non-allies between sessions. This makes alliances a major advantage if you want to work with people.
- 3. Betraying an official ally has terrible long-term political consequences, so is almost never done. If an official ally betrays you, announce it publicly, and you and your other allies will become that person's Enemy. The consequences for them can be dire.
- 4. If at the end of the game you are a formal ally of the person who becomes pope, your family will generally prosper and you will likely become rich and powerful.

Your character sheet will list your starting allies, and the communications rules for them.

NOTE: There are no pre-scripted betrayals in this game. If your character sheet says someone is your ally, they are a real ally. It's possible that an ally may decide mid-game to betray you for some more important goal, but they would need to have a very strong reason. Thus, you do have to watch your back, but only against in-game developments, not against pre-planted traitors.

Marriage Alliances:

Marriage alliances represent contracted betrothals promising that your relatives will wed. These make you Allies. You begin with a limited supply of “bride” or “groom” cards. To make a Marriage Alliance, players must use one “groom” and one “bride”. Cards specify the age of the “groom” or “bride” (i.e. “child,” “newly marriageable,” “adult,” or “older.”).

Betrothals must be within the same or adjacent age brackets, i.e. “newly marriageable” can be betrothed to a “child” or an “adult” but not to an “older” partner, while a “child” can only be betrothed to “child” or someone “newly marriageable.”

The player providing the bride must also give a dowry, i.e. money or other resources (jewelry, horses, houses). The groom, bride, and dowry must be given to an administrator, who will announce them and put them in a public place so everyone can see the alliance. A suggested dowry cash value is written on each bride/groom card. Players may choose any dowry both agree on, but dowries below expected value will result in an announcement of *Public Shame*, and high ones of *Glory*.

Some bride or groom cards specify that a Title goes with the Marriage. Bride cards which say “Automatic Dowry” mean that the dowry is paid by a third party, and neither family must supply money. Monastic leaders have Nunneries which count as “groom” cards, and Monasteries which count as “bride” cards.

Marriage alliances can be dissolved only in very specific circumstances. In the days *before* we elect a pope (when only a few weeks of in-game time are passing) marriages are technically marriage *contracts*, with the ceremonies not yet complete, so it is possible to dissolve the contract if (A) both families involved agree, and (B) there is a good reason to dissolve the marriage (you must explain the reasons to orchestrators).

Reasons could include a substantial change in the status of the bride or groom (for example if the groom was the younger son of a duke but his elder brother dies so suddenly he is the heir to a duchy), a major political shift which makes both parties feel things should change (for example the bride is suddenly the only bride that could make an essential alliance between France and Spain happen), a substantial rift between the families (for example the two realizing they are insolubly on opposite sides of a coming war), you get a letter from the bride or groom or a family member saying the marriage is a terrible idea for some specific reason (for example the bride really wants to be a nun, or refuses a groom too far below her in status, or the match is so controversial it causes riots in your city), or you realize that the marriage was based on a mistake in understanding the rules or politics (oops, I forgot England is allied with Portugal). **Marriages can only be dissolved before the pope is elected.** After the pope is elected, time is moving faster in-game, i.e. months per session instead of days, so marriages contracted in that period happen right away and can only be dissolved with a papal annulment.

Marriage Alliances **end if the bride or groom is killed** by an Assassin or the Roman Mob, or if the marriage is annulled by the pope. If a Marriage Alliance ends, the family that supplied the groom must return the dowry.

Some characters begin the game with marriages or betrothals already set – these can be ended by death or annulled by the newly-elected pope at the end of the game.

Cardinals cannot marry, but they can take mistresses. Anyone with a “bride” card can give it as a “mistress.” (“Child” brides can’t be mistresses.) You may have only one mistress at a time. Such mistresses generally become public after the pope is elected (keeping it secret is too hard, and Rome is used to the fact that cardinals do it all the time), though if the mistress’s family objects they may retaliate, though only if they are more powerful than the cardinal’s family. Taking a mistress creates an Unofficial Marriage Alliance, differing from a normal Marriage Alliance in four ways:

- (1) Whoever supplies the bride is a subject of public scorn for having a sinful relative.
- (2) The “bride” card representing the mistress counts as Evidence of Sinful Living if the character is investigated by the Inquisition.
- (3) Either player can dissolve the Alliance at any time at no cost.
- (4) No dowry changes hands.
- (5) Brides who are mistresses can *sometimes* also marry, and brides who are already marrying someone can sometimes become mistresses, but only (A) if *both* the groom *and* the head of the groom’s family (his father or uncle usually) agree to take on the terrible shame of the groom being married to a woman who is having an infamous affair, and (B) the bride and groom live (or plan to live) in the same city as the cardinal taking the woman as a mistress (you need to be able to get together, after all). If you want to do this, talk to the orchestrators so we can talk you through the process and help you figure out if it makes sense. We have blank bride and groom cards to make it possible.

Rank of Brides and Grooms:

Rank is very important, especially in marriage. Ideally everyone aims to marry people of the same rank or slightly better. As marriages are the way to make all important alliances, sometimes this cannot be managed precisely.

In the simulation, the social rank of a bride or groom is represented by letter grades, from A+ (the best groom in all Europe!) to F- (a poor commoner who would be considered a bad match by basically everyone). **A rank** means emperors, kings, dukes who are secure on their thrones, and their immediate heirs. **B rank** means other titled and landed high nobility, such as counts and lords, and their heirs, as well as younger children of kings who won’t inherit. **C rank** means untitled and unlanded high-ranked nobility, such as younger sons of dukes. **D rank** means minor nobles. **F is commoners.**

Marriages should not be arranged more than one letter grade apart. For someone grade A to marry C or below **would be a scandal**, for them to marry a commoner would cost them status and bring shame on the whole family. If a bride or groom is a natural child (illegitimate), they are one rank below where they would have been, which is changed should they be legitimated.

Legitimization can only be performed by the pope. Similarly, if someone is ennobled (given a title) by a monarch, they and their children will gain rank. If a commoner is knighted, they will become a minor noble, rank D-. When arranging marriages, look carefully at the ranks of brides and grooms to make sure they aren’t too far apart—marrying too low *or too high* can have negative consequences, for example making a powerful family seem to have fallen in importance, or making a humble family seem dangerously ambitious, inviting suspicion and retaliation from their neighbors.

Special Powers:

Some characters have one or more secret Special Powers. Most of them enable a player to be an exception to the rules in one specified way: pay half-price for something, dissolve an otherwise-insoluble contract, reuse a single-use item, strengthen an army, etc.

Important: The existence of Special Powers is out-of-character knowledge, not in-character knowledge; you should **never talk to another player *directly* about a Special Power**, though you may hint at it in a narrative way. Thus, you should not say “I have a Special Power that lets me give a defense bonus to a city,” or “My Special Power lets me commission that painting at half price,” but you may say, “I have a lot of experience defending cities in war, I think I’d be especially good at it,” or “I work with artists a lot, I bet I can commission that for a better price.” When in doubt about Special Powers, get an orchestrator (for those involving cards it can be wise to get an orchestrator first just in case.)

Section 3: Character Envelopes: Cards, Contracts, Letters

Most things in this game are represented by paper cards (usually tradable), which you will receive in an envelope. **Do not lose this envelope—we do not have a spare!** Your envelope will contain a unique set of color-coded cards representing resources such as Money, Courtiers, Property etc. Each card details its effects. When negotiating, you may show cards to each other freely—doing this represents sharing incontrovertible proof that you have the resource in question.

Cards come in three general categories:

- **Freely-Tradable Cards:** Money, Items, Courtiers, Public Papal Petitions
- **Limited and Non-Tradable Cards:** Titles, Sovereignty, Fealty, Debt, Special Power Cards
- **Expendable Cards:** Assassins and Armies

Freely-Tradable Cards:

Money:

You begin with Money, and can trade it freely at any time. Because these are mostly *political* upper-class rich characters who deal with government-sized sums of cash, money mainly travels in units of 1,000 Florins (note: Ducats and Florins were both gold coins worth roughly the same amount at the time). **1,000 Florins = \$1 million, the smallest unit of cash most of you care about.**

You will also see cards representing 100 Florins i.e. merely \$100,000 to pay for small things, and single coins worth 1 Florin = \$1,000, or 1 Soldo (a silver coin) = \$50. Single coins are too small to matter to anyone except low-level Vatican staff, and will be used for tipping employees when they're helpful.

Items:

Item cards represent specific objects, anything from a slice of cake to a castle in the Alps. Some have a cash value and may be used in lieu of money. Some item cards have special game effects written on the cards. Some items are physically present in the Sistine (like a slice of cake) while others represent the fact that you own a thing which you don't actually have in your pockets (like a palace in the Alps), so trading the card represents trading a deed to the object, but the object is not actually on your person.

While the Sistine is sealed, items may not enter or leave except for small items smuggled in letters or by other means; if someone in the Sistine is given an item by someone outside the Sistine (for example a diamond necklace) it usually means the item is not physically present, but represents a transfer of legal ownership of an object which remains outside the Sistine. **Some item cards are Priceless Items,** famous things whose presence can bring fame and tourists to a city or nation.

Debt:

Some characters begin in **debt**, usually to someone from the same city, or to one of the two main banks: the Medici Bank, or the Franciscan-run *Banca Monte dei Paschi di Siena*. Debt is

represented by a card in your folder. You can get out of debt either by repaying the sum listed on the card in cash or items, or by convincing your creditor to drop the debt. If you are in debt, one of your goals is usually to get out of debt (though sometimes debt lingers intentionally, notably the large sum the King of France owes to the Medici Bank in return for funds the previous king borrowed for his wars against England, which the Medici have never asked to have repaid).

Debt can be traded, so if you have debt you can offer to give that debt to someone else, in which case the other person then owes the money. Bankers and others who are owed debt may also trade or sell that debt, so, for example, if you are owed 5,000 Florins by Franceschetto Cybo, but you need cash now and he doesn't have it, you can offer to sell Cybo's debt to someone else for 3,000 Florins, in which case the other person then has the right to demand the 5,000 from Cybo. Creditors and banks may also choose to cancel the debt in return for favors, or as an act of kindness.

Courtiers:

A Courtier Card represents an artist, scholar, musician, or other person who works for you, and could work for another patron. Each Courtier is unique. Courtiers also give a place or ruler status in the eyes of the world, and the more different types of courtiers a court or place has (musician, artist, scholar etc.) the more it will increase status.

You can trade Courtiers freely to other characters who are capable of supporting them, i.e. you can give a Courtier to any monarch or cardinal, but not to most of the Functionaries since they do not have enough money to support a Courtier. Some Courtiers require you to spend Money on things like big art projects. A few Courtiers have limits on how they can be traded, for example some won't leave a certain place, or won't stay in a certain place.

Public Papal Petitions:

These cards represent a formal petition to be submitted to the new pope asking for a legal proclamation. After the new pope is crowned, he will grant a **limited number** of petitions. These will be read aloud in front of everyone at the Papal Audience after the pope's election. These usually involve matters of high politics which must be affirmed in front of the world. Petitions may relate to crowning a new monarch, endorsing an heir to a throne, legitimizing an illegitimate child, condemning an enemy, creating a new papal office, judging a dispute, exiling someone, excommunicating someone, or calling on the Crowned Heads of Europe to attack someone who is declared a threat to the Church. Public Petitions have the force of law in Christendom, and for many characters your biggest goal will be ensuring that a certain petition has the outcome you desire. The pope will only have time to address a limited number of Petitions before the war phase (or maybe none at all), so it is important to get yours near the top of the stack, especially if yours could affect the war.

For Papal Petitions to be read at the audience they must (A) be signed by a petitioner, and (B) turned in before the audience to Chief Secretary Gherardo Maffei, who is collecting them for the pope. When a petition is read aloud at the papal audience, everyone present will be invited to kneel before the pope and speak on the subject, but the pope must invite people to address him; otherwise no one may speak *except the Vice-Chancellor*, who has the unique special privilege to always speak at the audience. Traditionally the petitioner is always invited to speak, but others are invited at the pope's discretion. **The new Vice-Chancellor decides in what order the petitions are presented**, though Chief Secretary Maffei is encouraged to make suggestions since he has been collecting and organizing them.

Petitions may be traded, so, if you have a petition, you can give it to Chief Secretary Maffei at any time, or you can give it to someone else to hand in, or to show to others. Some characters may have a petition but want someone else to be the official petitioner if that other person is more likely to have the new pope's favor. Petitions have value beyond turning them in: for example, you can show a petition to an adversary and offer to *not* submit it to the pope in return for concessions, or you can show it to a potential ally to test his or her reaction. Some petitions you may choose not to hand in, but may find useful in other ways.

Limited & Non-Tradable Resource Cards:

Noble Titles:

Some characters (mostly Monarchs) can grant Titles. Receiving a Title increases Rank. Each Title card has a Rank. Titles are generally granted to people one Rank below the Rank of the Title, i.e. High Noble titles to Nobles, Noble titles to Commoners. Elevating someone 2 Ranks (i.e. to make a Commoner a High Noble) is **very unusual**. Many characters want to gain noble titles; some NPCs do too, so titles can be used, for example, to pay mercenary captains in lieu of cash.

Titles cannot be freely traded, they can only be gifted a single time by the title-granter to the receiver, though if you receive multiple noble titles you may gift one of the less valuable ones to one of your children or vassals, with the permission of the person who gave you the title. Most titles may be given to men or women.

Sovereignty and Fealty Cards:

Some characters are vassals or lords of other characters—this is indicated in your character materials, and represented by a Fealty Card in the case of vassals, and a Sovereignty Card in the case of sovereigns. Vassals are *expected* to obey their lords, and will usually reap rewards for helping their lords and meet punishment for failure or betrayal, but each player must judge when you would obey or disobey. Some characters are in multiple patron-client relationships, so, for example, the King of France holds the Sovereignty Cards for several French characters, while sometimes a character may be sovereign over someone and owe fealty to someone else.

Sovereignty and Fealty cards cannot be traded, but some interactions may cause you to gain or lose one, for example if you accept a noble Title from a Monarch (Duke, Count etc.) you also swear fealty to them and must obey their command (though this is not true if you just receive a knighthood), similarly if you join a Monastic Order you swear fealty to the Cardinal who is the head of that order, and if you are elected pope you owe fealty to no one and rip up all your fealty cards (keeping Sovereignty cards).

Player Character Courtier Cards:

Some low-ranked characters (mostly Functionaries) count as Courtiers, and may choose to come work for some more powerful person in return for a salary, home, and other support. These characters have Courtier Cards, and may give them to a patron of their choice. Once a player character has given their Courtier Card to a player, the functionary gains a new character goal, to help and advance the interests of their patron. Player characters' Courtier Cards cannot be stolen from them or taken by force, but once they give their cards to a patron, the patron may trade them as with other courtiers *and do not need to ask the courtier character's permission*, with the exception that

player characters' Courtier Cards may not be given to a direct enemy; if a patron attempts this, the player character courtier should talk to orchestrators about how to respond.

Port Cities:

Sea powers, like Venice, Genoa, or Portugal, Naples, or Aragon, may trade port cities to one another, increasing each other's wealth and reach at the cost of permanently reducing the tax revenue of the kingdom that has given up the port, a permanent price but sometimes worth paying in return for substantial aid. Port cities are **major resources**, and should not be traded lightly. They are represented by cards.

Port cities **may not be re-traded** without permission of the original holder, since the original holder is considered to still have strength in that port. For example, if Isabella of Castile gave the port of Valencia to France, France cannot then turn around and give that port to her enemy King João of Portugal unless Queen Isabella agrees.

Expendable Cards:

Brides, Grooms, and Monasteries:

Some characters have Groom or Bride cards (or Monasteries which count as Groom or Bride cards, since the person is married to the Church). These can be used to make marriage alliances, by being turned in to orchestrators (one bride and one groom) along with an appropriate dowry. In rare cases, if brides or grooms are kidnapped, the cards may be used to represent the hostage.

Spies and Assassins:

Spies and Assassins are one-time items, and can be traded before use, but have no value after.

Assassins, obviously, kill people; they **cannot kill players**, but they can kill NPCs, courtiers, and "bride" or "groom" cards, removing them from the game. You cannot kill someone in hiding until you know where they are hiding, but you can use spy actions (below) to help you find them.

Certain Courtiers, NPCs, "brides" and "grooms" (usually powerful ones like princesses) have bodyguards and are harder to assassinate, so you may need to send several Assassins after them. You may use multiple Assassins at the same time, or one at a time, gradually wearing the target down. However, **you simply cannot assassinate most monarchs**. They have too much personal security.

When you use an Assassin, give the card to an orchestrator and name the target. They will notify you whether the target is dead or simply wounded—unsuccessful attempts will still weaken the target and their defenses and make future attempts easier.

Spies: All assassins may alternately be used for non-lethal spy actions. Spies may only be used for spy actions and cannot be used for killing. Here are the spy actions:

- 1) **KIDNAPPING** may be attempted against Courtiers, Brides, Grooms and NPCs as long as you know where they are; simply state the number of Spies you send and an administrator will report success or failure.
- 2) **HELPING** with assassination attempts, strengthening Assassins. You still must spend one Assassin though.
- 3) **DEFENDING** Brides, Grooms, Courtiers & NPCs. Each Spy used increases defense by +1.

- 4) **SPYING** in Rome, by positioning the Spy/Assassin by a specified Cardinal's home or fortress. Doing this will give you information about the Cardinal's resources, which Courtiers, Brides and Grooms are in the house, and what letters (if any) are coming or going. Sending multiple Spies may even let you seize and intercept letters.
- 5) **INVESTIGATING** something: where someone or something is hidden, who was behind a kidnapping or assassination, interrogating suspects. The more cards you spend, the more you will learn. Usually more than one Spy will be needed, but sending even one will yield some information, while sending several may yield better information (for example one spy might tell you that rumor has it the kidnappers were French, while two spies might tell you which French cardinal sent them and what direction they went, three might capture one of the kidnappers and furnish *proof* of their master's guilt, and where they took the victim). Extra cards may be spent after an initial investigation to investigate more.
- 6) **OTHER STEALTH ACTIVITIES:** If you have an idea, ask an administrator.

Don't feel pressured to spend all your Assassin/Spy cards. Each card represents a man who works for you and serves your interests—if you don't send him on a mission, he will be on guard at your home, watching over your family and your stuff, aiding their defense. Even an unused Assassin or Spy card still helps you passively, even if you never use it actively.

Some characters have Spymasters and Spy Networks in specific areas (usually home cities) which provide reusable spy actions in that specific area—these require no card, but spending a card will strengthen their actions. If you have a spy network, your character sheet will say so.

Army Cards:

Some players start with Army or Navy Cards, i.e. forces they control. During the war phase some characters will launch attacks. **The Rules of War are explained in Appendix I.**

Armies are permanently controlled by the player who begins with them, but can be pledged to others. To pledge one of your Armies to someone, simply give the Army Card to that player. Armies can only be pledged by the owner; if you acquire an Army, you cannot trade it to a third party without permission from the owner.

Someone who has pledged an army can withdraw it at any time if they have good reason. If your personal goals do not mention Armies, then the only reason to acquire an Army is to trade it.

Some armies are **Mercenary Armies**, which can be hired for cash. The general going rates are as follows, but people may pay more if they're desperate:

50,000 = a normal price for one army in wartime; the commander and men will be happy.

40,000 = a good deal for one army in wartime; the commander and men will be ok

30,000 = a very low price for one army in wartime; Mercenaries will only go below 40,000 to help a kinsman or close ally or if they have another strong reason to give a discount. Paying less than 40,000 increases the chances that the men the commander will be looking out for extra sources of cash, increasing the chance of sacking and looting.

20,000 = bare minimum to feed and equip the men with no profit for them or the commander. A mercenary will take such low pay only to help a precious ally or if they get some other big reward, and it will be nearly impossible to keep them from sacking and looting.

Contracts:

Some players have Unsigned Contracts they can ask others to sign. For example, a representative of Emperor Maximilian might ask someone to sign a contract that, if that person becomes pope, he will give Maximilian his long-awaited Roman coronation. Each Unsigned Contract is represented by a parchment sheet with signature lines. The simplified contract sheet represents a formal legal document with actual signatures on it, so it can change hands, and if one person has signed it then subsequent people can see the signature.

While the game versions are simple to make them easy to understand, contracts represent formal, notarized Latin documents written out by fancy scribes, with many seals and witnesses, and legally enforceable. The formality of these contracts means:

- (A) It isn't possible to create new ones quickly and easily. The contracts you have in hand required weeks of preparation to create, so you usually can't invent new contracts during the game.
- (B) They are legally binding, and breaking them would have major political and legal negative effects, both in the courts and by making everyone distrust you afterward.
- (C) You can't make an illegal contract, for example to murder someone or to vote for a particular person, or judge a particular way in a legal decision (for example, if you become pope) since such things are against the law.
- (D) These are matters of **public record**, so it is difficult to keep them secret. They may be secret for a while, but there are copies in the hands of notaries, so unless you take steps to keep a contract secret (using spies or other means) others will be able to find out about the contracts you have signed using things like spies or spy networks.

To complete a contract, you need all the signature lines to be filled, and then must take it to the Orchestrator Desk to have it confirmed by a Notary; the Notary will cut the contract in half and keep one half, returning the other to you as your reference copy. A contract—even if signed—is only binding after it has been taken to a notary.

Contracts once signed may be broken, but doing so is VERY BAD AND RARE because it is a public betrayal with EXTREMELY SEVERE consequences, except in three very special circumstances (specified below). The reason the consequences are so severe is that the Renaissance patronage system runs on trust, and if you break a legal contract with someone, no one will trust your other contracts afterward. This affects all levels of society, from your powerful allies to the farmhands and weavers who work on your properties and supply your wealth.

When you choose to break a contract you **MUST** come to the Orchestrator table (with your envelope) and deal with the consequences *before* you take the action that directly breaks the contract. *You may not* evade these consequences by giving your resources to other players before coming to the table—you must face these consequences honestly as part of simulating the economy of trust:

1. You lose a large sum of money, usually equal to the funds you had when you began the game, sometimes greater if you gained wealth or status since. This represents the expenses of having many of your employees walk out on you, requiring you to hire new people at higher rates, work going unfinished. If you can't pay, you go into debt, or lose items or property.
2. Some of the Item cards you have representing items not in the Sistine may be stolen or destroyed in acts of arson or vandalism.
3. Most or all of your Courtiers abandon you—the orchestrators judge based on the personality of each Courtier what they do, and those that leave are taken by the orchestrators.

4. Most or all of your Spies and Assassins abandon you—orchestrators will determine how many, and you return the cards to the orchestrators.
5. You cannot receive new Courtiers or Spies or Assassins for the remainder of the game. Courtiers, Spies and Assassins used by others to help you may refuse to carry out the task.
6. All Players who are your Close Allies *also* lose some of their money, Courtiers, Spies, and Assassins, due to distrust from associating with you—orchestrators determine how much.
7. Your bride and groom cards all receive a permanent penalty to their Rank.
8. All your new Marriage Allies get the opportunity to dissolve the marriages if they wish—dowry funds will be dealt with by orchestrators based on the dowry law in each region.
9. Any mercenaries you have hired will refuse to fight for you, and will pull out of the deal, returning to you *only part* of what you paid them.
10. Your relatives and NPC allies will suffer consequences, communicated by letter. Depending on the severity of your betrayal, the consequences for your kin may include losing money or items, expulsion from political office, vandalism or arson of property, public scorn, bullying, banishment, violence, or even death.
11. If you or any of your family members are monks or nuns, you may face monastic discipline from heads of the orders; for players fasting or other mortification of the flesh, for your relatives harsh conditions and labor at their monasteries.
12. If you are subject to a ruler or legal system, you and your family will face typical period legal consequences for breaking a contract, such as a fine, imprisonment, or banishment.
13. The betrayal is publicly announced, having role-play consequences. Other players who have made contracts with you may be invited to break them, if appropriate.
14. Your character might be murdered at the end of the game. The less powerful you are relative to the person you betrayed, the more likely this is.

The special circumstances which allow a contract to be broken *without* these extreme repercussions are three, all of which largely come down to practicality and reasonableness, i.e. situations in which breaking the contract doesn't cause people to distrust you. These are:

1. **All parties involved in the contract agree to dissolve it;** for example, if you and another player both signed contracts promising to build a library in Paris, but then you both become angry with King Charles and decide it isn't a good idea to do it, if both of you agree to dissolve the contract then you can return to the Orchestrator desk and void the contract.
2. **A Special Power** directly interferes; for example if you sign a contract promising to have one of your architect courtiers build a library in Paris, but the courtier is targeted by a special power which makes them suddenly decide to join the Knights Hospitaller which requires that courtier to go to Rhodes, you may lose the ability to keep the contract—in such a case you should see if you can find another courtier, but if that is unreasonably difficult then you can return to the Orchestrator desk and void the contract.
3. **Circumstances change in an extreme way to make the original contract unreasonable:** for example if you made a contract involving a courtier but the courtier is assassinated, or you signed a contract to send your armies somewhere but then an unexpected civil war breaks out in your homeland and the armies are desperately needed at home; or you discover the person you made the contract with has betrayed you and murdered your brother. In large-scale betrayals, all contracts with the traitors can be voided, for example, if Crown Prince Arthur of England were assassinated, his father King Henry

would be freed from any contract or alliance made with those guilty of the murder, and would be expected to commit all his forces to avenging the dire deed, even if it means breaking earlier contracts about his troops.

If you think the circumstances are appropriate for you to break a contract, with or without facing the severe consequences, you must talk to an administrator first about why and get official approval.

Public Declarations: While records of all completed contracts are kept by the notary, and *can* be found out about if people try to do so (with spy networks and things), some contracts (clearly marked) are *Public Declarations*, meaning that instead of making a private contract the signatory is making a general public announcement, usually that they favor and endorse a particular side in a conflict (for example, endorsing a specific claimant to a throne). If you make a public declaration and bring it to a notary, it will be announced to everyone. There is no way to keep it secret—that's the point. You *can* sign one and then *not yet* bring it to a notary, but it isn't binding until announced.

Public Declarations aren't just you saying "I think France should get Naples," it means a serious commitment to that side: you've made a major public endorsement, sworn formal religiously-serious oaths, announced it at all your properties in many cities, staked your political reputation on supporting that side, sent orders to all your servants and relatives telling them to support that side, etc. If thereafter you suddenly switch sides, there are serious consequences, since your allies and servants will fear you might flip-flop dealing with them too—the consequences will be similar to but not quite as severe as normal contract-breaking, and almost always include faction allies (Guelph or Ghibelline) no longer trusting you.

Often a public declaration is a kind of workaround for situations where you can't legally make a contract. For example, you can't sign a binding contract saying "If I become pope I will give the Crown of Naples to France" since the pope has to make the official ruling based on a fussy legal process, but you *can* make a public declaration that you think the French claim is the best, and then when you're pope people will expect you to take that side, and trust you less (to a serious degree!) if you flip-flop. Public declarations are thus a good way to make sure someone has seriously committed to a side, but they can still be broken. They *cannot* be done in secret and still be binding—a complex tool for your political negotiations.

Letters, Letter-Writing, NPC Letters, and NPC Discord Interactions:

At some sessions, you may receive letters from characters who aren't at the Sistine (NPCs). Letters might come from relatives at home, brides and grooms, servants, allies, subordinates, even enemies. These letters are an important part of the game, connecting the monarchs and the Sistine to the world outside.

As a result of letters, Extra Resources may enter the game, in the form of new items, wealth, and support offered to players. If you get the opportunity to write a letter (some characters can do this), you can make specific requests, or describe problems and goals and see if NPCs can send you anything (or if they ask for anything!).

IMPORTANT: Letters are physical objects in the game. Letters can be shown to others, read, or stolen. A letter in hand is a useful way to prove you have support, and show allies what your other allies are planning, but it is also possible to steal or intercept letters. If you want to try to read someone's letters, you may either try to steal them during a session, or use a Spy to investigate. Most characters are sneaking letters in and out of the chapel by hiding them amongst the dishes of food

that come in and out of the kitchens, but some characters have private ways of sending letters which let them go faster. You may, if you wish, choose to destroy a dangerous letter by putting it into the “fire,” available at the orchestrator desk.

In addition to receiving formal letters, **a few of you will be put in touch via Discord with NPCs** with whom your character is in especially close contact.

Section 4: Combat, Violence, Betrayal, and Civil War:

Combat and Execution:

It is not possible for player characters to be killed by player actions in the game (though NPCs can be). It would be a shocking sacrilege for anyone to be killed in the chapel. But if you get on the wrong side of powerful people, you can be sentenced to death and executed after the game is over.

It is *not* possible for your character to be injured or beaten up during the game. Causing violence inside the chapel would be impossible to hide.

Being Arrested:

If a criminal is caught (someone sabotages voting, etc.) that person will be held for trial, but cannot be removed from the Sistine during the election, since the door is sealed. The Captain of the Papal Guard will take that person to some public part of the chapel and hold them prisoner there. Prisoners are held in public, and anyone may talk to them.

For simplicity, prisoners cannot escape unless someone who has access to a **secret exit** helps them escape. (If you have a secret exit and want to help a prisoner escape, talk to the organizers.) If you leave by secret exit, you will sit with the Outside Players and continue playing there. The fate of prisoners will be determined by the new pope at the end.

Betrays and Betrayal Bonuses:

Sometimes a player character may choose to betray another, by lying, deceiving, making a deal and then breaking it, acting as a double agent, etc. Betrayals are always results of player choice. While there are no pre-scripted betrayals in the game, some characters have goals which may be aided (or may *seem* to be aided) by betraying another player, so it is not uncommon for players to consider, and sometimes carry out, betrayals and deceptions. Examples of betrayals and deceptions include:

- Making a deal which depends on a marriage contract or a courtier, then assassinating the bride, groom, or courtier to undermine the deal.
- Signing a contract that *you* won't do something (like attacking a place), but secretly giving help to someone *else* so *they* can do the thing (i.e. attack the place) for you.
- Promising something knowing that you won't be able to deliver, for example promising someone papal benefices while knowing you don't intend to become pope.
- Ingratiating yourself with one faction but secretly selling their information to another.
- Persuading someone to give you a resource (armies for example) claiming you'll use them for one purpose, but really intending to use them for another.

Betrayal was a very serious thing in the Renaissance, since its society focused so much on trust, alliances, and patronage networks, so betrayals in the game—matching real history—have very serious consequences. For example, it was in the interest of *every* Renaissance noble family to help punish someone who assassinated a ruler, or a servant who betrayed his master, since making a severe example of the traitors would instill fear and obedience in that family's servants too. Jumping forward in time, when in 1537 a major member of the Medici family was assassinated, many surrounding powers helped them track down the conspirators over the following years, and even one who fled as far as Constantinople was arrested and handed over to them by the Ottoman Sultan

himself, since he was so offended by the act of assassinating someone from a powerful family, even one so distant from his own.

If a betrayal is kept secret, then it may work out very well for the betrayer, but secrets are hard to keep, so most in-game betrayals are exposed in time. If a major betrayal is exposed, all player characters will react to the news (often by distrusting and allying against the traitor, in ways which can change or even destroy your in-game hopes). NPCs will react as well, usually in ways which aid and strengthen the character who has been betrayed, since their allies will want to support them, and their servants and kin will be angry at the slight to their honor and want revenge. A player who is exposed as a betrayer may find that courtiers or mercenaries refuse to work for them thereafter, and that other NPCs may write to them in anger, or (if the offense is serious enough) dissolve alliances or treaties. Some consequences similar to those for breaking a Contract may also follow, (see Unsigned Contracts above) such as Courtiers, Spies, or Assassins refusing to work for you, your goods or funds being stolen or vandalized, and/or your Bride and Groom cards getting a penalty to Rank. And, of course, betrayers have a decent chance of being murdered at the end of the game, unless you are substantially more powerful than those you betrayed.

Conversely, a player who is the *victim* of a betrayal will receive help from a society that is shocked and angered by such a deed. You may receive letters and promises of help coming from many directions, and resources such as extra spies, assassins, funds, items, or even armies sent to them as aid. Additionally, the city or kingdom the victim comes from will often rally in anger when they hear of the deed, increasing the defense of that place or even creating new armies as people volunteer to join the army in great numbers, or seize their knives and pitchforks and take to the streets demanding restitution. These consequences of betrayal are designed to reflect the real historical reactions which cardinals and kings had to consider when they thought about betraying others.

The consequences of a betrayal come from the court of public opinion, not the law courts, caused by public outrage and opinion. Thus, victims of betrayal are also often allowed to dissolve some of the contracts they have signed, if the contracts no longer make sense given the betrayal. Getting someone to promise you something in a contract and then betraying them doesn't leave them locked into the contract, it means everyone (including the law courts who are in charge of contract law) will agree that you have violated the spirit of the deal and the contract is void. Similarly, if a king promised armies to a crusade, he may become unable to deliver the armies because his people will demand that his armies march to avenge the murder. If two kingdoms make a peace treaty but then one of them tries something underhanded, like assassinating the other's heir or helping another power attack them, then not only is the peace treaty void but the people in the betrayed kingdom will rise up in rage, demanding a war of honorable revenge, and making the wronged kingdom stronger.

Does betrayal always end badly for the traitor?

No.

These are the years Machiavelli observed, and sometimes betrayal, like violence or reigns of terror, *do* have exactly the effects the betrayer hoped for, achieving goals and weakening enemies. It can work, and if your character is one who would consider it then betrayal should be among the options you consider. But you must be careful. Everyone is familiar with Machiavelli's "It is better to be feared than loved," but he stresses just as much the second half of that conclusion, "but you must at all costs avoid being hated." Betrayal is one of the quickest ways to be hated **by players and NPCs alike**, and get into the kind of situation where your opponent doesn't mind going down in flames so long as you burn with them—that is very dangerous. So while underhanded deeds can be successful, it is very easy in this simulation to try something underhanded and have it backfire in

ways which destroy your goals, your family, even your homeland. It is particularly common for a character very near victory—for example someone with *almost* enough votes to become pope, or with *almost* the right treaties in place to conquer something—to try to use a betrayal or assassination to get that last step toward victory, and while it sometimes succeeds, more often than not when enemies' spy networks reveal the dastardly truth, it can end up backfiring in ways which destroy the very victory you wanted to achieve. Also, the more beloved and respected the person you betray, the bigger the consequences—if someone is hated by everyone, has few kinsmen, or is low in status, there may be no consequence at all to betraying them, but if you betray a very noble family, or a well-respected master diplomat, the consequences could be far greater.

In sum, betrayal is a part of the game, and can be a route to victory, but the consequences of betrayal ripple out through a big world in big ways, so be prepared. As in the real history Machiavelli lived through, the effects of betrayal are among the biggest shapers of our Europe in 1492.

Civil Unrest and Civil War:

In addition to wars of aggression and conquest, Civil Unrest and even Civil War can break out within a city-state, region, or kingdom. This can happen in the War Phase or before it, and may result in destruction, riots, the burning of characters' or NPCs' homes, murder or imprisonment of people's family members, even the overthrow of a ruling family. Civil War also greatly weakens the defenses of a place, making it much more likely to fall to attackers in the war phase. Civil War and Civil Unrest are usually triggered by situations such as:

- A player makes a highly controversial marriage alliance, such as marrying someone from an enemy city/kingdom/family, or someone much too high in status (suggesting ambition) or much too low in status (suggesting weakness and encouraging rebels).
- A rival claimant to a throne (such as an ambitious younger sibling of a ruler, one of the Pretenders to the English Throne, or young Gian Galeazzo Sforza the currently-imprisoned rival Duke of Milan) receives help from a player character to attempt a coup.
- Two different families from one city seriously attack each other, triggering their clients and partisans to fight (like Montagues and Capulets).
- News gets out of a terrible betrayal or other shameful action committed by a player character from/in that place, or against a character from/in that place, sparking public outrage.

Thus you need to think carefully about your family, homeland, and allegiances as you make deals and marriages, especially if there are major rival claimants to your throne, or you come from one of the vulnerable and volatile cities of Italy.

If civil unrest breaks out before the war phase, there may be violence, NPC deaths, or destruction of property, money, or items owned by characters, deaths of brides, grooms, or courtiers, and even major changes in power, status, and influence if, for example, a ducal family is overthrown in a coup. It will also affect NPC actions and letters in major ways.

Section 5: Monks, the Inquisition, & the Roman Mob:

Monastic Orders:

Some Characters are members of Monastic Orders and have taken a Vow of Obedience to higher members of that order. Legally, the leader of a Monastic Order has near-absolute power over other members of the order, and can command them to do things, have them imprisoned, exiled to a dingy hermitage, or force them to go on crusade. In practice, severe authority is rarely used against Cardinals for fear their families will retaliate, but it can be used, especially against less powerful Cardinals. Monastic Orders compete with each other for fame, influence, new recruits, and donations, so they are rivals, especially between the two new fashionable orders, the Dominicans and Franciscans.

- **Dominicans:** Scholar monks, who run the University of Paris and the Inquisition, and are favored by Spain. Cardinal Carafa is the leader, and the Inquisitor General is a member.
- **Franciscans:** Focused on poverty, love & outreach to the poor, favored by France. They run a bank, the *Banca Monte dei Paschi di Siena*. The head is Francesco “Samson” Nanni; Cardinal Della Rovere is a member. Because Saint Francis was dedicated to poverty, unlike other monks, Franciscans **cannot own any property at all**, and all their property belongs legally to the pope, so the pope can walk up to any Franciscan at any time and demand the shoes off his feet or the cloak off his back, and the Franciscan must hand it over. In practice, Franciscan cardinals tend to live in lavish palaces which legally belong to their kin. This means Franciscans cannot be fined, since they don’t own property.
- **Benedictines:** This is a respected, older order federation of monastic organizations, focused on library-building, tradition, and disciplined life.
- **Knights Hospitaller:** (the Order of St. John of Jerusalem) Crusader Knights from powerful families, who battle the Ottoman Empire. They wear a distinctive white cross symbol to mark membership. The leader is Cardinal Pierre D’Aubusson, and Cardinal Bembo is a member.
- **There are actually many more kinds of monks than this, but we are simplifying.**

The Inquisition:

The Dominicans run the Inquisition. They can prosecute people for Crimes. Some characters have Evidence of Crime, meaning you are guilty of a crime, or sometimes that you are innocent but there is so much circumstantial evidence that you would certainly be convicted regardless. There are three types of such evidence:

- “Evidence of Heresy,” (i.e. holding a radical theological position)
- “Evidence of Sinful Living” (i.e. breaking vows of chastity)
- “Evidence of Simony” (i.e. paying or accepting bribes to get into office).

The Inquisition’s **Secret Archive** has a file on every character summarizing the evidence of their crimes or innocence. It takes effort to collect these documents, so the Inquisition can only investigate a few people per session. In some cases, the crimes detailed in the archive are *already notorious* (for example, Cardinal Giuliano della Rovere’s daughter Felice and Cardinal Borgia’s several

children are evidence of sinful living, but everyone already knows about them). Revealing already-notorious crimes does very little except for reminding those who care deeply about virtue of the crimes of others, but exposing crimes that are *not already notorious* then the consequences will be greater. If the Inquisition chooses to investigate you, and finds evidence of crimes *not already notorious*, there will be one of two consequences:

- (1) The Inquisitor may show you the evidence but offer you a chance to repent and resolve the situation privately by making a “donation” (bribe) to the Church; the Inquisitor may decide how much. “Donations” paid to Inquisitors are kept by Inquisitors.
- (2) The Inquisitor may instead denounce you publicly, revealing the evidence of your crimes.

If this happens there are consequences:

- *Some* characters will substantially change how they feel about you, and may become unwilling to ally with you or vote for you. These reactions will vary person by person, and crime by crime. Some characters couldn’t care less if you’re guilty of bribery, but might take heresy very seriously, while others might not care much about theology but take violence very seriously. In general everyone knows there are many Cardinals who have had love affairs, illegitimate kids, and committed simony, so exposing that kind of crime may not get much of a reaction, but some characters may be guilty of more severe crimes, or may have reputations for being extremely pious, and lose those reputations if secret corruption is revealed. How you react to learning of someone’s crimes is 100% your call, based on your character’s opinions.
- You must pay a fine; for Cardinals this is 10,000 Florins per type of crime *not already notorious*, for Functionaries it is 1,000 Florins. This goes into the papal treasury. If you cannot pay, you go into debt to one of the banks.
- Your Allies *may* choose to dissolve their alliances with you if they wish.
- If any Player Character Courtier gave you their courtier card voluntarily during the game (i.e. not ones you had before it started) they may choose to take the card back, leaving your service.
- You must show all your current Courtier cards to the Inquisitors, and they may choose to arrest your courtiers as complicit in your crimes, removing them from the game.
- If you have a Spy Network, it may be weakened since fewer people want to work for you.
- If you are a military commander, your Commander Bonus may be weakened when you lead troops in the War Phase, since they have less confidence in you.
- In the case of Functionaries, the new pope can decide to have you imprisoned, fined, or executed, though not until the end of the game. In the case of Cardinals and Monarchs, the new pope will consider whether to excommunicate you and/or banish your family from Rome.

Some Inquisitors consider humanism to be a form of heresy (paganism!), but there has not been a papal judgment on the question. The Inquisitors have a petition to the pope asking him to decide; if humanism is declared a heresy, then everyone who has *already notorious* evidence of humanist sympathies in the archive will be simultaneously prosecuted for heresy under the rules above, and the Inquisition will gain the power to arrest any/all Humanist Courtiers.

Some investigations may expose more serious offenses, like murder, or someone sneaking into the Conclave under false pretenses; in such cases the Inquisition may turn people over to the Captain of the Guard, and, unless the player escapes or is pardoned, they will be executed at endgame.

The Roman Mob:

The Roman Mob is simultaneously the most and least powerful player in the game. This is not a mob in the organized crime sense, it is the actual population of the city of Rome rioting or rising in arms. The Roman Mob traditionally riots whenever a papal election stretches on too long, especially if it looks like a foreigner (or worst of all, a Frenchman!) might become pope. The Roman Mob decides its own actions, but tends to listen to the Cardinals from Roman families.

The Roman Mob can kill people who are in Rome. Each “bride”, “groom” and Courtier card specifies whether the person is in Rome (vulnerable to the Roman Mob) or abroad (safe.) Other people may also be in Rome who aren’t represented by cards.

In addition, most Cardinals have some amount of property in Rome, specified in your character sheet. The Roman Mob may choose to destroy this property at any time. If that happens, a DM will inform you, and you have suddenly incurred a debt of several thousand Florins. The Roman Mob can also damage Rome and the papal palace, which drains money from the Papal Treasury (see below).

If you incur debt due to the Mob destroying your property, you must either give that amount of money to the orchestrators, or go into debt (pick which of the two banks to owe money to). Inform that banker, and the orchestrators will prepare debt cards for you.

The more damage the Mob does to Rome, the lower Rome’s defense value becomes, making it vulnerable to invasion in time of War.

Section 6: Election of the Pope:

The Papal Treasury:

The new pope will, after the election, receive the Papal Treasury. He may use it to pay his debts, if any. The size of the Papal Treasury is variable. It begins the game at 100,000 Florins. It decreases if the Roman Mob destroys part of Rome. If the Mob is particularly destructive, the treasury can be empty, or even negative, so the pope begins in debt. The treasury increases whenever someone pays a fine after being convicted by the Inquisition. The Treasury is overseen by the Vice-Chancellor but directly administered by the Papal Treasurer (Valentino Borgia) and the Papal Banker Cardinal de Medici, so they will be held accountable by the new pope if money seems to be missing. The pope may call for one or the other to be exiled if they have committed embezzlement.

Benefices and *Papabile* (candidates for the papal throne):

While any Cardinal could be elected, some are recognized as *papabile* “pope-able” i.e. likely. Cardinals are declared *papabile* when someone (even themselves) endorses them. The names of *papabile* are public for all to see. You can declare yourself *papabile* at any time, assuming you are a cardinal and old enough.

One major thing each pope gets to do is distribute Benefices, desirable Church Offices which come with immediate money, long-term money, and special powers or privileges. Receiving benefices is one of the major things that makes cardinals and their families powerful, so they are very desirable. Some of these offices are currently vacant or always filled by new popes, while others are powerful administrative positions which the new pope *may* choose to reassign, but which usually stay with one office-holder through many popes, so that reassigning that offices would be *unusual*, but the new pope may have reasons to redistribute them, for example to give them to people he trusts more,

or as rewards to supporters or punishments to adversaries. **Each *papabile* receives a Benefice Pledge List, which they can fill out promising offices to specific people**—writing someone's name on the list is considered a **binding promise** to give that person the office if you are elected pope, so breaking the promises has the usual (severe!) negative effects of promise-breaking. There are nine High Vatican Offices, and several other offices. Each comes with particular powers, and a salary. **If you (or your family member) receive an office, you get your annual salary immediately.**

THE NINE HIGH VATICAN OFFICES:

- **The Three Vatican Administrative Offices**

- o **Papal Camerlengo: (sometimes replaced),** salary 5,500 (\$5.5 million/year)
 - Highest office: administers papal household, pope's most intimate assistant, has 24-7 access to the pope, acts in the pope's place when necessary.
 - Counts as a functionary: has access to the Functionary-only area.
 - At the papal audience, has the unique privilege that, when people approach and kneel before the throne seeking permission to speak about a particular Public Papal Petition, the Camerlengo can call on people and grant them the privilege to speak *even if the pope does not*.
 - Current office-holder: Cardinal Raffaele Riario
- o **Vice-Chancellor of the Church: (sometimes replaced),** salary 2,000 (\$2 mil./year)
 - Overseer of the Vatican Curia, administration, secretaries, functionaries etc.
 - Counts as a functionary; has access to the Functionary-only area.
 - Decides what order papal petitions are presented in.
 - At the papal audience, has the unique privilege of speaking at any time, *even if the pope does not invite him to*.
 - Current office-holder: Cardinal Rodrigo Borgia
- o **Legatus General: (rarely replaced),** salary 1,500 (\$1.5 million/year)
 - Chief Vatican diplomat, overseeing envoys and diplomatic appointments.
 - At the papal audience, may always speak freely during petitions regarding appointing Papal Vicars or other Vatican diplomatic positions.
 - Current office-holder: Empty, Cardinal della Porta just retired

- **The Three Vatican Theological Offices**

- o **Major Penitentiary: (rarely replaced),** salary 3,500 (\$3.5 million/year)
 - In charge of absolution for extraordinary sins, like desecrating the host or doing violence in the Sistine; oversees forgiving excommunicated people.
 - Has the unique privilege of retaining contact with the outside world even during the election, since granting absolution is often urgent.
 - While there is no pope, the Major Penitentiary can pardon excommunicates.
 - At the papal audience, has the privilege to always speak freely during petitions regarding excommunication or extreme sins.
 - Current office-holder: Cardinal Giuliano della Rovere
- o **Master of the Sacred Palace: (rarely replaced),** salary 1,500 (\$1.5 million/year)
 - Pope's chief theological adviser, highest theological authority in the Church.
 - At the papal audience, has the privilege to always speak freely during petitions regarding points of doctrine. Traditionally has always gone to a Dominican.

- Current office-holder: Inquisitor General Torriani
- o **Postulator General: (rarely replaced)**, salary 1,000 (\$1 million/year)
 - In charge of evaluating and approving new saints
 - At the papal audience, has the privilege to always speak freely during petitions regarding saints, angels, and canonization.
- Current office-holder: Cardinal Giovanni “Achilles” Sangiorgio.
- **The Three Vatican Military Offices**
 - o **Standard-Bearer of the Church: (usually replaced)** salary 15,000 (\$15 million/year)
 - Highest-status military office in Europe, supreme commander of papal armies. Sometimes given as a title of honor to people who don’t actually lead the armies, such as a very young nobleman, or an old and retired one.
 - Recipient must be noble, usually a kinsman or marriage ally of the new pope. Generally this office does not go to a churchman.
 - Counts as a High Noble title, 1 Army.
 - Current office-holder: Count Niccolò di Pitigliano Orsini
 - o **Captain General of the Church: (usually replaced)** salary 10,000 (\$10 million/year)
 - Practical field commander of papal armies. About 50% of the time this title is given to the same person as the Standard-Bearer, 50% a different person.
 - Recipient must be noble, usually a kinsman or marriage ally of the new pope. Generally this office does not go to a churchman.
 - Counts as a High Noble title, +3 Armies.
 - Current office-holder: Count Niccolò di Pitigliano Orsini
 - o **Governor of Castel Sant’Angelo: (usually replaced)** salary 5,000 (\$5 million/year)
 - In charge of the papal fortress, Vatican defenses, and the papal prison.
 - Recipient must have practical military training, and is usually a very trusted kinsman of the pope. Recipient can be a churchman or a layman.
 - Current office-holder: Cardinal Domenico della Rovere di Vinovo

Additional Positions the Pope Distributes:

- **Cardinalship** x 4: **Recipient (or their family) gets 10,000** Florins immediately, and permanent political power since he (or one of his relatives) becomes a Cardinal. This is in many ways the most important benefice, because it gives a vote in the next election. Securing cardinalships can help guarantee you pick who gets to be the *next* pope after this one. The distribution of cardinalships will be considered carefully in the endgame.
- **Abbacy** x 2 These are vacant positions as head of a wealthy abbey, bringing lots of money. There are two vacancies to fill. **Recipient gets 15,000** immediately, 8,000/year for life.
- **Armies** x 5: the papal armies, usable anywhere in Italy, or beyond if navies ferry them. There are also 4 armies that go with the Vatican military positions, for a total strength of 9 armies.
- **Promise of the Golden Rose:** Each pope may give one (only one) Golden Rose to a nation, city, church, or person; it’s a literal rose sculpted from gold, but also one of the highest honors in Europe. Cities rename streets after it if they get one. The Golden Rose is a *priceless* item, boosting Status.

Once a *papabile* has written a name into his list of appointments, it is a binding promise, unless the person whose name was written down agrees to yield the position. Each *papabile* has a benefice

sheet. At the end, only the sheet belonging to the cardinal who becomes pope determines who gets the offices—all others are meaningless. A *papabile* who comes to office must honor his promises, unless something (like a betrayal, kidnapping, or Special Power) interferes. Benefices are a big negotiating tool in trying to win votes, but a candidate is **not required to distribute all benefices**—any left at the end, the pope keeps for his family. Offices are announced at the Papal Audience.

Canonizing New Saints:

One important task and function of the papacy is to confirm which celebrated pious dead people are really saints, i.e. are really in Heaven doing miracles to help people, and which are popular superstitions but not confirmed.

There are currently forty popular figures who have been nominated for sainthood and gone through the preliminary steps of the process, but awaiting the formal canonization process, but making a new saint is slow and complicated, involving years of interviewing witnesses about the candidate's life, deeds, and miracles to verify they really are a good person for people to pray to for help.

For this reason, the pope we elect will only have time to evaluate and confirm or reject a maximum of six saints from a list of forty candidates. Cardinal “ACHILLES” Sangiorgio is the Postulator General, the official in charge of the process of picking which saint candidates to nominate for the pope's attention. Over the course of the simulation, Cardinal Sangiorgio will be reducing the list of forty candidates down to five to nominate to His Holiness—in addition to these, the pope has the privilege to personally pick one from the rejected list if he wishes, for a total of six. At the end of each day, you will receive an update about which saint candidates have been cut out of the list, and which are still in the running as the list narrows from forty, to thirty, to twenty, to ten, to the final five.

There is no voting or detailed mechanic for this, the process of selecting from the list is entirely up to Cardinal Sangiorgio, but most characters have a few favorite saint candidates you hope will make the list (for personal or political reasons) so many will want to talk to Cardinal Sangiorgio and influence his decision.

THE VOTE ITSELF, and the threat of INVASION:

To become pope, someone must receive a majority of votes. Each Cardinal has one vote. Non-Cardinal players do not vote. It will take several rounds of voting to reach a majority. Votes will be held three times during each session. Each time, each Cardinal writes who he is voting for on one of his vote forms. Vote Counters tally votes and announce the results. Cardinals may not abstain, though if sick or incapacitated, the vote might proceed without them. It will probably take four or five votes for a pope to be selected.

Vote Counters are not Cardinals but functionaries. They are players. It is public knowledge that they know who really voted for whom, and they may choose to act on or sell this knowledge (doing so is forbidden by the rules of the *Vatican*, but 100% allowed under the rules of the game)

After each vote, vote-counters will announce the results and write the number of votes received by each candidate on a public board.

INVASION: When Rome is weak, the Ottomans attack. *Everyone in the game sincerely believes that if the election takes too long, Ottoman forces will invade Italy. If this occurs, (1) Whoever had the plurality in the last vote becomes pope, (2) all players lose half their money, (3) the Papal Treasury is emptied, and (4) all small wars are abandoned in favor of a defensive war. This will happen at the end of Day 3 of the simulation if no pope has been elected.*

Choosing who to vote for: You may vote for any Cardinal, but here are some guidelines:

- Usually you should not vote for a Cardinal who is too young; one man being pope for several decades is too dangerous. Any Cardinal younger than 40 is too big a risk.
- Cardinals avoid voting for personal enemies except in very special circumstances.
- Cardinals are nationalistic and prefer a fellow-countryman to a foreigner, unless the fellow-countryman is a personal Enemy. Most non-Italian Cardinals would rather have an Italian pope than a rival non-Italian (i.e. a Spanish cardinal is bad for France, etc.)
- Voting for someone who was convicted by the Inquisition looks bad, but you can do it.
- You CAN vote for someone who is not officially a *papabile*, as long as they are a cardinal and old enough.
- Votes for non-cardinals or for cardinals who are too young should be counted as an abstention.
- Sometimes cardinals who can't win pool their votes to elect a Compromise Candidate, someone old and likely to die soon, ensuring there will be a new election shortly. If there is deadlock, or an Enemy may win, supporting a Compromise Candidate is a great tactic.

Section 7: After the Election come the consequences...

(If the pope is elected in the last vote of a session, most of these things will happen the next session.)

The Coronation Ceremony

(The ceremony will be run by the Master of Ceremonies)

- 1) The new pope will be announced by the Vote-Counters. He will come to the front of the chapel and be crowned **by the Papal Chaplain**.
 - a. When one becomes pope, all one's feudal bonds are dissolved, so if the pope owes fealty to anyone (including a monastic order) he rips up his fealty cards. (This may be done serenely, or pointedly if the pope is angry at his former lord...)
- 2) As the pope sits on his throne, the pope will call all Cardinals and others present one-by-one to kneel before him and pledge their loyalty. This is also the moment that the pope appoints his inner circle. *The order in which he calls people is very important!* It represents how much this pope intends to honor, listen to, and reward each person.
- 3) After the Cardinals, the pope will call functionaries to approach, kneel, and pledge. The pope *may* choose to call a favored functionary *before* an out-of-favor cardinal—this is a *big deal*.
- 4) Finally, the Outside Players—the Crowned Heads of Europe and other ambassadors—will enter the Sistine to pledge their obedience to the new pope. The pope will call them up one-by-one. The order in which he calls them *is extremely important*, since it indicates how much the pope intends to favor each nation in Europe, and the first power he calls forward can expect many papal blessings. **This Concludes the Coronation.**

The new Camerlengo, Vice-Chancellor, Major Penitentiary, Master of the Sacred Palace, Postulator General, and Legatus General are announced (or the former ones reconfirmed) during the process of calling up the cardinals to give their oaths. The pope simply calls up his chosen appointee using their position title as he does so, which tells the former office-holder (if there was one) that he must come hand over his badge of office. For example, if the pope said “I call my Vice-Chancellor Cardinal Rodrigo Borgia,” would reconfirm Borgia as Vice-Chancellor, who would go up and take the oath and thank the pope for the position. If the pope instead “I call my *new* Vice-Chancellor Hadrian Castellesi,” then Hadrian would go up, take the oath, and thank the pope for the position. The pope may *optionally* thank the former office-holder for their good work, which invites the former office-holder to say a few words before going.

Popes also usually appoint a female relative to be **Vatican Hostess**, and run the papal household. The pope will often announce his hostess among the functionary oaths.

Sometimes when calling up a Franciscan, the pope will ceremonially demand the shoes of his feet, as a reminder of the Franciscan pledge to absolute poverty, since everything a Franciscan is wearing is legally the pope's property. This is done *either* to mark the pope's *displeasure*, or to mark *great papal favor*. In the case of a Franciscan the pope greatly favors, the pope will say “I saw a beggar outside who has no shoes,” inviting the Franciscan to give up his shoes as a public demonstration of his generosity and humbleness, a great opportunity to look virtuous in a very prominent place. In the case of a Franciscan the pope greatly *disfavors*, the pope will often say something like, “A humble man walking the path of Saint Francis should need no shoes,” and the Franciscan must hand them over,

and the pope then dumps them on the ground clearly taking them away just for spite. Will our pope choose to do either? Exciting question.

After the Coronation (before or after the Papal Audience as time permits):

- 1) The new pope receives money from the Papal Treasury. Cardinal de Medici and Treasurer Valentino Borgia may be called upon to explain themselves if the funds are unexpectedly small, or large.
- 2) The **New Vice-Chancellor** decides which of the Functionaries to re-hire, and assigns their new salaries. All functionaries are considered unemployed unless the Vice-Chancellor chooses to re-appoint them—unemployment can be devastating for a poor functionary.
 - a. The Chief Secretary intends to retire. The pope must choose a new Chief Secretary.

The Papal Audience:

After the pope receives the oaths of loyalty, he will hold a Papal Audience, to announce **Papal Bulls** (proclamations without debate) and grant **Public Petitions**. If there is time, there may be a short Papal Audience on the day the pope is elected; if not then the Papal Audience will be the next session. During the Audience, Cardinals sit, while others stand.

The Vice-Chancellor will receive the petitions from Chief Secretary Gherardo Maffei, and read them out one by one. **The pope rarely has time for more than 10 or 12 petitions before the War**, so the order is very important, and asking the functionaries in advance to make sure your petition is toward the top can make a big difference.

Petitions which are not addressed will be officially unresolved as war begins, but may be addressed after the war. When a petition is read, those who care about it are invited to kneel before the pope to signal that they want to be called on to speak. The pope *may* choose to call on one or more petitioners, or may decide without calling on anyone—often those in disfavor must accept judgments in silence. Speaking *without* being called on is a grave violation of protocol, and can result in arrest, torture, fines, and/or expulsion from the Papal Audience. The pope must move quickly through each petition, since there is little time, but should allow at least a couple people to speak about most petitions.

If the pope crowns the Emperor, he may invite the emperor to sit as a colleague. If the Emperor sits with the pope when a petition is read, he may publicly support the pope's answer, which makes it even stronger. If the Emperor remains silent, however, this can weaken a papal ruling.

Announcing new cardinals happens at the papal audience, by the pope reading out the list of those receiving the cardinalships. In some cases he may give a cardinalship to a specific named person, for example "Prince George of Coimbra, Natural Son of King Joao of Portugal," or in some cases he may simply say, "A worthy son of the [X] family," meaning it will go to an unspecified but appropriate member of that family. Gaining cardinals means wealth and power at the next election.

Canonizing new saints also happens at the papal audience, and places which get a new saint may be strengthened in the war as a result. Toward the start of the audience the pope will call up Cardinal Sangiorgio the Postulator General to present the list of five finalists who may be canonized. If His Holiness wants to do a sixth at his discretion, he must tell Cardinal Sangiorgio ***before*** the audience to tell Sangiorgio which saint he wants to add to the finalist list, so Cardinal Sangiorgio is ready. His Holiness may then decide Yes or No immediately, or he may choose to invite people to argue for or against a particular finalist. He may canonize any number of saints from zero

to six. Saints he rejects are not necessarily rejected forever, but may be examined again in a few decades.

During the papal audience, you should mostly listen to what happens, since big issues will be decided which affect everyone, but it is also okay to sneak off to the corner for quiet negotiations, so long as you never miss being called on by the pope—that would be a grave insult to His Holiness!

After the Papal Audience, WAR BEGINS. The war rules are included in an Appendix. **There is no need to read the War Rules if you will not be commanding armies.** The war mainly involves those who possess Armies and Navies telling the orchestrators what orders they give their troops—orchestrators then calculate the outcome. **At the end of Day 3, by 9 PM, every player must email the orchestrators to tell us *where you are*** (Rome, Paris, with an army, in your country estate) so we know whether you are or are not in danger from the war. For most players, that's all you need to do.

The results of the war will be calculated over the long weekend gap between Day 3 and Day 4. Since armies are in the field, far from most characters, orders can't be modified after the evening of Day 3; beyond that it's up to the field commanders what happens. A few players who are (A) physically with their armies or (B) in locations under attack may be contacted with questions (for example "An army is approaching your city, do you surrender or fight?" or "The army you are riding south sees a French army heading west, do you hail and parley with them, attack them, or continue south?") Other than that, no one takes any action with the war. **The war takes several years of in-game time**, so in addition to the war results, announcements at the end of the war phase will include details such as the births of new children, or the deaths due to disease or old age of some non-player-characters.

A couple of player characters are old or sick, and died of natural causes between the election of 1492 and the end of the subsequent wars. Thus, while no player can be killed by player action, those players whose characters died soon after 1492 will be given a choice, either to continue as normal and decide that in our alternate history their characters lived a little longer, or to say their character did die, and to play the final sessions as a ghost. This can be a fun change in some cases, but is up to each individual.

After the War:

Day 4 takes place after the war. It will be half free time, for people to mix, half Papal Audience at which more papal petitions and negotiations take place in response to the war.

All characters receive income after the war, in the form of new cash, and sometimes items—this cash can be spent on Day 4. Your income represents a combination of your salary, income from any land you own or other property, income from bribes (dependent on your political clout and status as the war ends, often much larger than your salary!), and, for rulers and conquerors, the value of the taxes you collect from places you rule, sacked, or conquered. If you sacked cities, you may also receive treasures, items, and prisoners (courtier cards) captured in your conquests; the wealthier and grander the city the greater and more famous the treasures. If you did not rise or fall greatly in power, your income will usually be roughly half your starting money, and most cardinals will receive an income of between 5,000 and 20,000 florins (mostly from bribes). If you are in debt, you may receive little or no income, or even go deeper into debt.

The first issue resolved Day 4 will be ransoming of prisoners, if any player characters were captured in the war. Players who begin Day 4 as prisoners will sit in an area representing their captivity, and can negotiate for their freedom. Anyone can approach that area to negotiate with captives, and the captors should linger in that area for negotiations. Players may specify any ransom they wish for their prisoners, and any character may offer to pay any other character's ransom.

Monarch Prisoners: By ancient custom, anyone holding a ruling monarch (kings, queens, or the Emperor) **must** agree to free that prisoner when the subjects of that ruler raise a literal King's Ransom, *which they always will*. Captured monarchs should negotiate with their captors and may work out their own deals, but if the captor refuses the monarch's offer, the King's Ransom contingency will go into effect, and the captor *must* accept the King's Ransom raised by the people, which is equal to 3x the annual tax revenue of that kingdom, usually between 200,000 and 300,000 Florins. The captured monarch must then be sent home safely, but as a result of the extreme financial burden on the people, the ruler's domain is *economically devastated*, taking a decade to recover, and the monarch receives no income, goes into debt, and will be remembered negatively for centuries to come.

Cardinal Prisoners: By ancient custom, a cardinal cannot be held prisoner long-term except by the pope himself. Captured cardinals should try to negotiate ransom with their captors, which may be anything the characters agree on. If no compromise is reached, the pope may demand that the imprisoned cardinal be handed over to the pope, to do with as he wishes. A cardinal imprisoned by the pope himself has no one else to appeal to.

Functionary or Courtier Prisoners: By ancient custom, patrons are expected to ransom their courtiers, and any patron who fails to do so will be severely censured by society (unless special circumstances such as a betrayal intervene). If a functionary or courtier-rank prisoner has no patron, or their patron is unable or unwilling to ransom them, they should negotiate with their captor, or can offer their services to their captor in return for freedom, resulting in the handing over of the character's courtier card, and (often) the creation of a fealty card representing the debt of obligation. Courtiers who secure release by promising to serve their captors must do so faithfully—if they betray their new captor/patron, society will condemn them, and make it trivial for said captor/patron to have them tracked down and killed at the end of the simulation (no assassin card needed!).

Any prisoner who is not ransomed in the free period at the start of Day 4 can continue to attempt to negotiate for their freedom. If that fails, they end the simulation imprisoned, and *can* be executed by their captors at the end of Day 4.

After the ransoming comes the post-war papal audience. At this audience, the pope will address petitions not settled before the war. New petitions related to the war results may be put in, and the pope may be called on to confirm conquests or crown new rulers.

In addition, there is a tradition in the Renaissance of trying to make peace by inviting powerful people on opposite sides of recently-settled conflicts to become co-godparents of the same newborn prince, so His Holiness may baptize some high-profile newborn heirs resulting from major marriages, and invite some pairs of adversaries to be co-godparents and pledge friendship and mutual support of the child in its future life.

One Final Vote: The Next Pope

Time allowing, this will be a single round of voting held at the end of Day 4. Rather than seeking a majority, orchestrators will use the outcome of this vote to predict the likely next pope, and the next pope after that, based on the pattern of support from different votes. This final vote will be very important to our prediction of the long-term fates of the families and places in the simulation.

In the final vote, the College of Cardinals is different, since some cardinals will die before the next election, and new cardinals will be created. When the time comes for the final vote, orchestrators will announce which characters get to vote (based on the real death dates of these historical figures, modified for causes of death affected by the war), and how many votes each gets to cast. Some characters, whose families received extra cardinalships, or otherwise thrived, may get to cast several votes. Others whose families lost power, and whose cardinal did not outlast the current pope, may cast none. Some votes will be cast by orchestrators representing new powers who gained influence in Rome in the intervening years.

While some characters and families will care deeply about this final vote, and may try hard to get others to vote for them, it will be very different from the multi-round intensity of the main vote, **more like a straw poll to indicate which families are strong or weak**, and important as we discuss the aftermath of our events, and how our timeline differs from reality. Players whose goals do not hinge on becoming pope should not worry too much about this final vote, except for thinking about where you want to throw your strength if you still have some as the simulation ends.

When Things Go Wrong...

This is a *very complicated* simulation, and inevitably sometimes things will go wrong. When that happens, we'll roll with it together, and the orchestrator team thanks you in advance for your patience and collaboration as we bring to life a process with so many moving parts. When something goes wrong in a way that seriously weakens or hurts a particular player in ways that are unfair and can't be fixed, we have extra assets that will go into play to help make up for it, in the spirit of: *When one bridge has been burnt, we build another!*

For example, if your efforts to negotiate an alliance are ruined by someone accidentally leaking a vital plan to an enemy, we can't fix the enemy knowing, but we may make up for it by having a powerful new NPC contact you offering a different alliance, or a great treasure falling into your hands.

So, if at some point things seem to be going wrong, just remain calm and explain the problem to the orchestrator team, and we'll bring in solutions and options. And thank you in advance for understanding!

Appendix I: Status—the Splendor of Courts & Churches

This section is mainly relevant to Monarchs and their supporters—others may skim or skip it. Monastic orders have a separate Status competition, explained two pages after this.

The grandeur of a ruler's court (your seat of power where you have your throne, audience chamber, courtiers, ceremonies, ambassadorial receptions etc.) has huge political consequences: impressing ambassadors, delighting the people, intimidating potential rivals, attracting artists and ambitious people who want to work for the best, and projecting your legitimacy and power.

All Monarchs have starting Status, and can achieve things which increase Status, meaning your seat of royal power has become more awe-inspiring. Mainly you gain Status by collecting Courtiers, Priceless or Legendary items, and getting the pope to support your Public Papal Petitions. **Status has a direct effect on the war**, making people more or less willing to join your armies.

- Average starting Status for a monarch is 40
- For each 2 Status above 40 that you have at the end of the game, you get +1 defense in the territory where your court is located. For Isabella, Castile; for Charles, Paris, etc.
- For each 4 Status a monarch gets above 40, they get one additional army.
- If you start the war phase with the *most* status, you get one additional army.
- For each 4 Status a monarch gets below 40 (you can lose status by trading away resources), you suffer a -1 penalty to defense in *all* your territories.

Status is calculated after Day Three. At the same time war orders go in, all Monarchs (including the pope) report by email to the orchestrators all their courtiers, Priceless items, relevant achievements etc. Status changes thus:

- Courts gain +1 Status per Courtier resident in their capitals at the end of Day 3.
- Courts gain +1 Status for each different occupation of Courtier resident in their capitals end of Day 3 (i.e. during the war). When one Courtier has multiple occupations, you may choose which one to count, but you may only count one occupation per Courtier.
- Whichever Monarch ends Day 3 with the most Courtiers gets +3 Status.
- Whichever Monarch ends Day 3 with the fewest Courtiers gets -3 Status.
- “Priceless” and “Legendary” items, such as exotic objects or antiquities, each give +1 Status.
- **“SPYMASTER” courtiers do not contribute to Status in any way! They are secret!**
- **Canonizing new saints also affects Status by affecting morale. A new saint may grant as much as +4 or -4 Status depending on the Saint's relationship with your polity.**

Each Monarch also has unique factors which can increase or harm your Status. In general:

- Monarchs gain Status from having high-status marriages, and lose Status from low-status spouses or marriage troubles (separation, bad rumors, etc.)
- Monarchs lose Status if rival claimants to their thrones make trouble, and gain Status if rival claimants to their thrones yield their claims and publicly support the current Monarch.
- Most Monarchs gain or lose status if certain Public Papal Petitions are granted or denied.
- Monarchs gain +1 Status if they do at least two of the following things:
 - Fund at least one artistic or literary project in a major European capital.
 - Fund/found at least one new monastery or church.

- o Pledge to send at least one army or navy on crusade, if the crusade happens.
- o Ransom at least one prisoner (from the Ottomans, or a kidnapping).
- o The Monarch (personally), or the Monarch's direct heir, marries someone from a family of equal or higher station. For example, Ferdinand and Isabella's marriage boosted their Status, but Henry's to Elizabeth of York only helped him *within England*.
- Monarchs lose Status if they marry too far beneath them, marry their heirs too far beneath them, or fail to reward and stand by their loyal allies & vassals.
- Emperor Maximilian can gain Status by achieving his second and third coronations (in Milan and Rome), or lose status if it becomes clear he will never get them.

Note that all Courtiers and Items present at the Court contribute to the total, whether or not those Courtiers belong to the Monarch. For example, **all French Cardinals who return to Paris after the election contribute their Courtiers to the splendor of the French Court**—French Cardinals who reside in Rome do not. Similarly, if a Cardinal traveled to England with Courtiers, those Cardinals would count for Henry's court. Currently King Charles & Queen Anne reside in one court and share Status; if Anne goes elsewhere, their courts will separate and they will have separate Statuses. Currently Queen Isabella and her King Ferdinand reside at separate courts; if they agree to reside in the same court their Statuses combine. For the pope's Status, all Vatican Functionaries re-hired by the new pope, and all Courtiers belonging to the pope, his relatives, and the four people appointed as the pope's four closest advisers, contribute to the Status of the Papal Court.

After the War, Status will be Recalculated! Gaining or losing territory affects status, and courtiers and priceless items can be stolen or destroyed when places are sacked or captured. After the war, orchestrators will calculate how each Monarch's status has changed—if your Status increases greatly, you will get extra support and your negotiations in the end will have extra force behind them, while if your lands are conquered and your Status declines you may find hardships, lack of influence, or debt awaiting you. The specific effects will vary, depending on the particular events of the war.

The Monastic Status Competition:

This section is mainly relevant to monks and their allies—others may skim or skip it.

Monastic Orders compete for Status too. **Monastic status has no military effect, it only determines which order surpasses the others in influence at this important turning point. The consequences are on the decade and century scale, not short-term.**

The Franciscans, Dominicans, and Benedictines (the orders we are focusing on) begin with status 35 (equivalent to a powerful duke) and the Knights Hospitaller with 27, but in fact the main competition is between the Franciscans and Dominicans, newer orders which are growing rapidly. The Benedictines, who have been stable for hundreds of years, and the Knights, who mainly care about war, don't care much about this competition, but should either of them end with higher status than the Franciscans and Dominicans it would be an embarrassment to both.

The order that ends with the highest Status wins the rivalry for a generation, gaining wealth and power.

Monastic Orders gain and lose Status in the following ways:

- +4 for a new saint who is a member of your monastic order.
- +2 Status for each priceless item (usually holy relics).
- +1 Status for every two valuable relics (worth at least 5,000 but not priceless) the monastery gets.
- +1 Status for amassing four or more minor relics (worth less than 5,000).
- +1 Status for each artist, musician, or sculptor Courtier the monastery possesses at the end of the last day.
- +1 additional Status for each complete set of one artist, one musician, and one sculptor the monastery possesses at the end of the last day (must be three separate courtiers, not one with multiple skills).
- +3 Status for official papal favor.
- +1 Status for each different noble family powerful enough to rule a place (city-state, kingdom etc.) who has a bride or groom card from their family join the order, becoming a monk or nun (i.e. making a marriage alliance with a monastery bride card or nunnery groom card).
- +1 Status for each Cardinal *under the age of 40* who joins the order, swearing monastic fealty to the head of the order. Older cardinals have already had long careers & are not appropriate as new recruits.
- +1 Status for each *new* monarch that endorses that order above all others.
- A monastic order loses status if they lose a major relic (in trade or war).
- A monastic order loses status if they lose the support of their current patron Monarch, i.e. that Monarch chooses to favor a different order, or loses power through war, coup etc. The patrons are:
 - Castile for the Dominicans
 - France for the Franciscans
 - The Benedictines have no current patron, though England has favored them recently.
 - The patron of the Knights Hospitaller *should* be the King of Naples who is also King of Jerusalem, but Ferrante was declared illegitimate by the last pope; to gain a patron they need the new pope to acknowledge *someone* as King of Naples, that person needs to actually hold Naples at the war's end, and they need to an endorsement from that person.
- A monastic order can lose status if there is a large scandal involving notable members of the order (for example if Evidence of Sinful Living, of Simony, or of Heresy is exposed).

Each monastic order also has a unique way of gaining status:

- **For the Franciscans:** each city-state ruler that chooses to use the Franciscan bank over the Medici one, the Franciscans gain +1 status. If a Monarch or the pope does so, +2 Status instead.
- **For the Dominicans:** For each successful investigation by the inquisition which reveals evidence of a crime that is not already notorious, +1 Status. If they expose serious heresy, +2 Status.
- **For the Benedictines:** For each item card representing a library or collection of multiple books, +1 Status; for every three individual book items +1 Status; for every library project completed +1 Status.
- **Knights Hospitaller:** +1 Status for each navy that *actually* goes on crusade; +1 for every 2 armies that go.

Appendix II: The Rules of War

Armies have a specific origin, and must be able to get from that origin point to the place they are attacking — either with permission of the rulers of the lands in between, by naval ferry (one Navy can carry one Army), or by fighting their way through.

Navies do not have a specific origin, but are either **Mediterranean, Atlantic, or Both**, and those designed for one area cannot be used in the other (the waters are too different). Mediterranean navies can attack the ports on the southern border of Portugal but not the western border of Portugal, and must pass through the strait of Gibraltar (controlled by Castile) to reach their targets. Navies originating in the Atlantic which are capable of entering the Mediterranean (i.e. the English “Both” navies) must also pass through the strait of Gibraltar.

When Armies or Navies are committed to *attack* a place, they can, if successful, move on to attack an adjacent place immediately. For example, if ten Armies were committed to attack Milan, and Milan’s defenses were six, the attacking army would succeed, and would have four extra armies which could then attack Genoa, Ferrara or Florence, since these border Milan. Thus, when giving orders to armies, the orders can contain multiple steps, for example “Attack Milan, then, if successful, attack Genoa, then, if armies are left over, go to Florence and help defend it.”

When Armies or Navies are committed to *defend* a place, they cannot be relocated to another place if they are not attacked. **HOWEVER** if an area has defensive armies but no one attacks it, and an *adjacent* territory is attacked, then the commander of the defending force **MAY** be contacted and given a chance to use their armies to help defend or attack that adjacent territory. Similarly, armies can be ordered to *stand by* in a place, in which case they may get a chance to react to nearby combat, for example “Stand by in the mountain pass between Milan and France.”

If your army originates far from the place you want to attack, and you want to pass peacefully through one territory to attack another, you must **secure permission from the ruler of the territory you intend to march through**, or you will likely face attrition and resistance. For example: “Pass from France peacefully through Milan to attack Florence” requires the permission of the controller of Milan. In the case of Coastal places, this rule applies to armies only, not navies.

Any navy may attack any coastal territory without passing through anything. For example, for a French army to attack Portugal the command: “Pass peacefully from France through Milan, Tuscany, and the Papal States to attack Naples” requires the signature of the rulers of Milan, Tuscany, and the Pope, but a French Navy can sail from France’s Mediterranean port and from there attack Naples without anyone else’s interference.

In case of civil war or rebellion within a city (i.e. Florence, Rome, Genoa etc.) both sides are tallied by their army total alone and neither side receives a defense bonus. In the case of a civil war within a nation (i.e. France) the original ruler receives the defense bonus. If you commit troops to a civil war and then that territory is attacked, you will have the option to change and join with your local enemies to defend the territory against outside attack.

You may, if you wish, commit an army to someone unconditionally by contacting the instructors to specify an unconditional trade. It may then be used anywhere—you cannot recall it.

STEPS OF WAR: Occurs at the End of Day 3.

1. **The War Deadline is 9 PM on Day 3.** We ask those with simpler war plans to try hard to get them in well before 9 PM.

2. **All players must email orchestrators by the War Deadline** to specify in what location your character spends the war. Usually this will be a city, or characters with Commander Bonus may choose to travel with an army in the war. Specifying your war location is important, since characters can be captured in war, and characters present at places with battles will be contacted by orchestrators to make decisions about what you do (flee, surrender, fight etc.), If you do not tell us your war location, orchestrators will decide, based on your character.
3. **Everyone who has an Army or Navy in hand** must email **the organizers** by the war deadline to specify how you are using your armies and navies. Instructions may have multiple steps, but must be simple:
 - a. For defense, write “Defend Milan” or “Defend Provence.”
 - b. For simple attacks, write “Attack Milan” or “Attack Provence,” taking care to specify how you reach your target if it isn’t obvious (i.e. if you have safe-passage through an intervening territory.)
 - c. To attack a sequence of places, write them in order: “Attack Milan, then Genoa, then Pisa, then Florence.” War will continue until the armies run out or finish the list.
 - d. For civil war, write the place and faction, i.e. “Help the Medici in Florence,” or “Help the Colonna in Rome,” or “Help Countess Margaret Pole in England.”
 - e. You may order “Stand by in X place,” in which case the army will be there and, if other armies attack something nearby, your army may get to respond.
2. **Special powers, courtier powers, items etc.** which affect combat must also be committed by the war deadline, and your intended uses of them explained along with the army orders. You must specify whether any **Player Characters, courtiers, or major NPCs are with your army**, so we know whether they provide combat bonuses, are in danger of capture, etc.
3. Since orders are given by the player holding the army/navy card, but require approval from the original owner of the card, after we receive war orders, orchestrators may check with players if the orders we receive for your armies seem like ones you might not approve. We will only do this when we have strong reason to doubt that a specific army would follow orders (for example a Milanese army being ordered to leave Milan when Milan is in danger).
4. If your Player Character is (A) in a place where armies attack or (B) with your armies, you may be contacted by administrators, who may tell you what you see from where you are, and give you opportunities to make decisions for the place and people with you.
5. If an army is standing by somewhere with no combat, but nearby areas see combat, you may be contacted by orchestrators to ask whether you want to send your armies there.
6. Results of the war in all places will be announced to everyone simultaneously.

NOTE: Do you play war strategy games (*Europa Universalis*, *Crusader Kings*, *Imperator: Rome* etc.)? This war is *not like that!* Once your armies leave, you will have very limited information, and—unless you’re with your armies—little control. Your field commanders will follow your orders as best they can, but will make their own decisions when facing emergencies, setbacks, betrayals, bribes offered by enemies, etc. This simulates the real experience of waiting blindly in the capital for weeks for news of what's happening, not the impossibly detailed tactical info standard in videogames.

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- **Wealth ratings** indicate how profitable it is to take a particular territory. **There are two numbers.** The first represents what you get *immediately* (usable Day 4) **if you sack** the territory. If your commanders go rogue and sack the territory, they get that value instead. The second is the long-term value of holding the territory, reflecting both economic and agricultural power and how hard or easy it is to extract said wealth. Some large lands are not fruitful, while some tiny cities are rich. If the territory is sacked, taxes go down near-term.
- “Navy” armies count as +2 armies, but can only attack “Coastal” places.
- Land armies must move from their origin region to a target before attacking. For example, to attack Greece from Poland you must pass through Hungary, with permission or by force. Armies may be ferried from port to port by Navies; one Navy can carry one Army. The Navy may, after ferrying one army, be deployed as normal.
- It is well known that Isabella of Castile can blockade the Strait of Gibraltar. This makes it hard but not impossible for navies to pass through (they will lose a lot of strength on the way).
- This table shows major lands outside Italy; Italy is a separate table, as are small ports.

Territory Name	Defense	Coastal?	Sack	Taxes	Controlled by
Scotland	7	Coastal	60,000	30,000	James of Scotland
England	6	Coastal	120,000	90,000	Henry of England
Ireland	5	Coastal	0	0	Henry of England
English Holding in France	4	Coastal	30,000	10,000	Henry of England
Brittany	4	Coastal	90,000	90,000	Anne of Brittany
Normandy (Northern France)	4	Coastal	180,000	90,000	Charles of France
Paris Region (Central France)	4		275,000	200,000	Charles of France
Provence (Southern France)	4		200,000	240,000	Charles of France
Portugal	6	Coastal	180,000	150,000	João of Portugal
Castile (Central Spain)	5		200,000	150,000	Isabella of Castile
Aragon (Eastern Spain)	5	Coastal	180,000	120,000	Ferdinand Aragon
Sardinia	1	Coastal	30,000	30,000	Ferdinand Aragon
Sicily	3	Coastal	90,000	90,000	Ferrante of Naples
Burgundy – France-held Half	3		75,000	90,000	Charles of France
Burgundy – Empire-held Half	3		75,000	90,000	Emperor Max
Central Empire	???		150,000	90,000	Emperor Max
<i>The empire has many pieces; invading armies will capture some pieces—the larger the victory the more pieces.</i>					
Disputed Borderlands HRE	3		90,000	60,000	Emperor Max
Austria	3		90,000	90,000	Emperor Max
Poland	5		90,000	90,000	Casimir of Poland
Brandenburg	3		60,000	60,000	Vladislaus/Barbara
Bavaria	3		90,000	90,000	Vladislaus/Beatrice
Hungary (Central)	4		90,000	90,000	Vladislaus/Beatrice
Egypt	5	Coastal	120,000	60,000	Qa’it Bay of Egypt
Transylvania	3		60,000	30,000	Vladislaus/Beatrice
Greece	3	Coastal	40,000	40,000	Sultan Bayezid II
Constantinople	3	Coastal	30,000	30,000	Sultan Bayezid II
Ottoman Empire (Crusade)	???		Vast!	Vast!	Sultan Bayezid II
<i>The empire has many pieces; invading armies will capture some pieces—the larger the victory the more pieces.</i>					

War Within Italy:

Note: Cities ruled by mercenaries, such as Urbino, Mantua, Bologna, & Rimini, have extra defenses if their armies are at home, but lower if their armies are hired to fight elsewhere.

Territory Name	Defense	Coast?	Sack	Taxes	Controlled by
Turin (Savoy)	3		70,000	50,000	Duke Carlo Amadeo
Milan (Lombardy)	4		150,000	90,000	Ludovico Sforza
Genoa (<i>port</i>)	3	Coastal	120,000	90,000	Sforza, della Rovere
Padua	2		90,000	50,000	Venice
Venice itself is invincible, but harmed if Ferrara and Padua fall. You must control Ferrara to attack Padua.					
Ferrara	4		120,000	60,000	House D'Este
East Path: Through Romagna (east of the mountains, part of the Papal States)					
Mantua (ally of Urbino, <i>mercenary</i>)	2+army?		90,000	30,000	Francesco Gonzaga
Mirandola (Papal States)	1		30,000	15,000	Count Pico
Forlì (Papal States)	2		30,000	15,000	Caterina Sforza
Urbino (Papal States; allied with Mantua, <i>mercenary</i> , has ?? armies)	2+army?		120,000	60,000	Guidobaldo da Montefeltro
Bologna (Papal States, <i>mercenary</i>)	2+army?		90,000	60,000	Pope + Bentivoglio
Rimini (<i>port</i> , <i>mercenary</i>)	1+army?	Coastal	60,000	30,000	Malatesta (mercenary)
West Path: Through Tuscany (west of the mountains, <u>not</u> part of the Papal States)					
Florence	3		250,000	90,000	Medici? Republic?
Pisa (<i>port</i>)	3	Coastal	30,000	30,000	Florence
Volterra	1		60,000	30,000	Florence
Siena	2		60,000	30,000	Florence/Piccolomini
On Both Paths: Lazio (west of the mountains, part of the Papal States)					
Viterbo	1		30,000	15,000	Alessandro Farnese
Rome	Variable		120,000	30,000	Pope + Roman Mob
<i>Rome's defense varies with the popularity of the pope, the mood of the Roman Mob, & the Orsini & Colonna feud</i>					
<i>Optional:</i> Ostia (Rome's port)	3	Coastal	N/A	30,000	Pope
Southern Italy:					
Sora (border of Lazio & Naples)	2		30,000	30,000	Della Rovere
Kingdom of Naples, Mainland	4	Coastal	180,000	special	Ferrante of Naples
<i>If you take Naples you get tax income of 20,000 from each of Naples, Capri, Amalfi, Salerno, Squilace, Bari, & 5,000 from Otranto, unless you lose them through trade or war. When taking the area you may choose to sack any of the six, getting 20,000 wealth for each, except for Otranto which has not rebuilt enough to be sacked again.</i>					
Kingdom of Naples, Sicily	3	Coastal	90,000	90,000	Ferrante of Naples
Sardinia	1	Coastal	30,000	30,000	Ferdinand of Aragon

Italy also contains several small port towns, like Savona, Salerno, Pescara, and Bari (these represent many more but we are simplifying). Ports may be separately attacked by navies in the War at Sea (outlined below), otherwise they change hands automatically if nearby ruling cities change hands, i.e. Genoa controls Savona, and Naples controls Salerno, Bari, and Pescara. If a previous ruler of Genoa or Naples traded these ports away, it is up to the conqueror whether to honor the trade.

War at Sea (Sea Ports)

There are many **islands and trading ports**, which frequently change hands through trade/diplomacy or war/conquest among sea powers: Venice, the Ottoman Empire, Genoa, Portugal, Aragon, Castile, and Egypt. Navies (not armies) may be committed by any sea power to defend current port holdings, or to try to take ports away from others. Since navies move fast, you may (unlike with land battles) give Mediterranean navies orders to defend your holdings and then attack things if you are not attacked. For example, you might give the order:

“Three Portuguese fleets will defend Portugal’s ports, but if Portugal’s ports are not attacked, these navies will try to take the port of Bari from Naples.”

Some sea ports are **towns**, while others are large, bustling **cities** so the port is one part of the city, and the *port* can change hands while the *city* remains subject to the local ruler. Others are **fort cities** with huge defenses, which give military strength in addition to wealth. Ports have a Quality grade indicating their economic value, and a Tax value. **After the war, owners of ports (including their original owners if they kept the port) receive the Tax Value in cash, to use on Day 4.**

Port Name	Type	Controlled by	Defense	Quality	Tax
Porto	Town	João of Portugal	3	A	60,000
Lisbon	City	João of Portugal	4	A+	80,000
Faro	Town	João of Portugal	1	B	40,000
Albufiera	Town	João of Portugal	1	C	20,000
Cádiz	City	Isabella of Castile	3	A	60,000
Malága	Town	Isabella of Castile	2	B	60,000
Almería	Town	Isabella of Castile	1	C	20,000
Valencia	City	Ferdinand of Aragon	2	B	40,000
Barcelona	City	Ferdinand of Aragon	2	A	60,000
Oran	Town	Sultan Qa’it of Egypt	2	B	40,000
Algiers	City	Sultan Qa’it of Egypt	4	A+	80,000
Sète	Town	Charles of France	1	C	20,000
Marseille	City	Charles of France	2	A	60,000
Savona	Town	Sforza/della Rovere	1	C	20,000
Ravenna	Town	Venice	2	B	30,000
Rimini	Town	Malatesta (mercenary)	1+army	B	40,000
Fiume (<i>only Hungarian port</i>)	Fort City	Vladislaus of Hungary	5	A+??	100K ?
Squillace	Town	Ferrante of Naples	1	C	20,000
Pescara	Town	Ferrante of Naples	1	C	20,000
Bari	Town	Ferrante of Naples	1	C	20,000
Otranto	Town	Ferrante of Naples	0.5	C-	10,000
Vloré	Town	Ottoman Sultan Bayezid	1	C	20,000
Corfu	Fort City	Republic of Venice	6	B	40,000
Patras	Town	Ottoman Sultan Bayezid	2	B	40,000
Kuşadası/Ephesus	Town	Ottoman Sultan Bayezid	2	B	40,000
Rhodes	Fort City	Knights Hospitaller	7	C	20,000
Kavalla	Town	Ottoman Sultan Bayezid	1	B	40,000

Fiume is Hungary’s only port—its tax value is very high but varies with the wealth of Hungary.

Atlantic ports, plus Ostia, Genoa, Pisa, Venice, Constantinople, & Naples (which defends Amalfi & Salerno) are not listed because they can’t be held by small fleets, and must be taken in the main war.